# CLASSES & THE MANTLE SYSTEM

**In *Corsair*, your Class is not an abstract RPG profession, cultural caste, or permanent biological destiny. Instead, it represents an advanced, proprietary MANTLE (*Modular Adaptive Neural Transmission Linked Equipment*)—a specialized, aerospace-grade cybernetic and technological chassis engineered for high-intensity tactical operations across planetary gravity wells and the void.**

While civilian spacers and commercial security guards rely on standard vac-suits and off-the-shelf ballistic armor, Corsair operatives and fleet specialists wear MANTLEs. These fully integrated tactical rigs synchronize directly with the wearer's central nervous system, translating split-second subconscious impulses into overwhelming kinetic, thermal, chemical, or molecular force.

## 1. THE NEURAL CONTROL CHIP (NCC)

At the heart of every MANTLE rig lies the **Neural Control Chip (NCC)**. Permanently fused into the base of the operative's skull and cervical spine, the NCC interfaces directly with major motor nerve clusters and sensory pathways through an array of sub-dermal optical conduits and cranial shunt ports.

Operating a MANTLE is not like picking up a rifle or donning a set of body armor; it requires extensive neuro-physical conditioning, biometric calibration, and mental discipline. When an operative jacks into their chassis, the NCC establishes a closed-loop telemetry bridge:

- **Reflex Synchronization:** Actuator servos, capacitor banks, and manifold solenoids respond to motor intentions at the speed of neuro-chemical impulse—bypassing the mechanical latency of physical triggers or levers.
- **Sensory Telemetry:** The operative feels the condition of their chassis as a natural extension of their physical anatomy. A Conduit feels electrostatic charge prickling along their peripheral nerves; a Hazard perceives fluid pressure within their Catalyst Chamber as visceral chest tension; a Pilot senses external drone hull-stress as direct proprioceptive pressure.
- **Air-Gapped Isolation:** Because early neural experiments in human history proved vulnerable to electronic intrusion, all NCC architectures utilize strict, air-gapped optical buses. A MANTLE never communicates with external wireless networks without hardware-isolated firewalls, protecting the operative's brain from cyber-warfare intrusion or rogue signal resonance.

Once surgically installed and bonded to the operative's spinal column, the Neural Control Chip remains a permanent part of the character's body, ready to interface with any authorized MANTLE chassis they acquire.

## 2. ORIGINS & DISCOVERY

The technology underpinning modern MANTLE rigs was born out of survival and desperation across two centuries of Newcomer history.

### THE VAULT DISCOVERIES & EARLY COVENANT (14-60 AA)

Following the founding of Crossroads and the historic alliance with Stormdrinker on Nimbus, early Newcomer researchers venturing into dormant Precursor Vaults discovered fragments of ancient, air-gapped optical-neural bus architecture. While the cosmic purpose of these relics was kept contained under the Covenant's charter to prevent cosmic beacons from firing, cyberneticists studied their inert conductive pathways, laying the theoretical groundwork for bio-compatible neural interfaces.

### THE SCAVENGER INCURSIONS & ABE-REDMANE SKUNKWORKS (315-320 AA)

In 315 AA, the peaceful expansion of the Fume cluster was shattered by the **Scavenger Incursions**—brutal raider armadas composed of biologically modified Scav clans. When Scav boarding parties sacked Cloudspire and ambushed civilian transports, Newcomer defense militias were outmatched in close-quarters void combat by the raiders' terrifying biological reaction speeds.

Facing fleet extinction, Commander **Velen Redmane** rallied an independent coalition of spacers and engineers at the **Port Zenith Orbital Engineering Yards**, suspended in the upper atmosphere of Landfall. Redmane commissioned Chief Fleet-Engineer **Kira Abe** to weaponize vault-derived neural bus conduits into an emergency combat harness.

Working around the clock in Port Zenith's zero-gravity skunkworks, Abe's team created the first generation of closed-loop **MANTLE** prototypes. By linking heavy tactical systems directly into the wearer's motor reflexes, strike teams could match and exceed Scav agility in zero-g boarding actions. Equipped with these experimental rigs, Redmane's coalition routed the raiders at the decisive **Battle of Fume Rings (320 AA)**, leading directly to the birth of the Flotilla and the signing of the Skyline Accords (335 AA).

In the two centuries following the Battle of Fume Rings, MANTLE technology evolved through continuous refinement across dozens of production blocks. Early military engineers incorporated dragon biology research—studying the efficient bio-electric resonance of dragon scales and nerve tissue—alongside new discoveries extracted from deep Precursor vaults and hard-won industrial telemetry from the Drift Wars. By the time of the Frontier War (485-508 AA), the MANTLE had matured into the defining tactical platform of modern void combat.

## 3. THE 518 AA REALITY

In the present day of **518 AA**—ten years after the Fall of the *Evergaol* and the signing of the Great Truce—the production, possession, and maintenance of MANTLE rigs are shaped by post-war realities.

#### MANTLE ACQUISITION PIPELINES (518 AA)

- **1. Sponsor Candidate Pipelines:** Official patron underwrites NCC surgery and issues a certified fleet rig during elite training, pending Oversight Committee charter.
- **2. The Freelancer Network:** Grassroots fraternity of Corsair veterans and dockside armorers passing down repaired, surplused, or salvaged frames to promising aspirants.
- **3. Post-War Salvage & Black Markets:** Decommissioned war stock or battlefield salvage from the Frontier War repaired in orbital chop-shops and retrofitted with jailbroken firmware.

### FLOTILLA CONTROL & LEGAL STATUS

Under the Law of the Void, the Flotilla High Council classifies combat-grade MANTLEs as **Tier-1 Restricted Military Hardware**. Licensed production is tightly restricted to major orbital naval foundries (such as the Bastion Yards at Port Zenith), and unauthorized possession in orbital transit lanes carries severe criminal penalties. However, under the **Skyline Accords (335 AA)**, planetary governments hold sovereign authority within their atmospheric gravity wells, allowing surface colonies, private corporations, and frontier syndicates to license and deploy their own proprietary variants.

For commissioned **Corsairs**, possessing a top-tier MANTLE is an official entitlement of their charter. When an operative joins a chartered cell, their individual Sponsor (Flotilla, Colonial administration, Megacorporation, Union, or Private patron) legally registers and underwrites their chassis, granting them cross-jurisdictional authorization to carry lethal tactical hardware across both orbital space and planetary soil.

Uncommissioned **Freelancers (Aspirants)** acquire starting frames through sponsor candidate pipelines, the informal **Freelancer Network** of veterans and dockside armorers, or restored Frontier War battlefield salvage calibrated in dockside cyber-clinics.

## 4. THE FIVE BESPOKE CHASSIS

While every MANTLE interfaces through the standardized Neural Control Chip, physical chassis are **not** interchangeable modular shells. Each class represents an entirely bespoke, dedicated full-body frame engineered from aerospace alloys, micro-servos, and specialized tactical hardware:

- **The Conduit:** Engineered as a living capacitor suit, featuring spine-mounted graphene-dielectric plates, subcutaneous energy conduits, and shoulder Peltier thermoelectric heat sinks that vent excess thermal and cryogenic bleed during high-voltage Amp and Burst cycles.
- **The Hazard:** An armored chemical warfare harness housing a pressurized thoracic Catalyst Chamber, micro-solenoid mixing valves, hermetically sealed reagent reservoirs, and chemical-resistant fluoropolymer conduits routed to transdermal dermojets.
- **The Pilot:** A motorized bio-mechanical exoskeleton frame equipped with cranial high-frequency telemetry uplinks, heavy solid-state battery banks, reinforced skeletal shock-absorbers, and dorsal magnetic docking clamps that host an autonomous, articulated Exodrone.
- **The Vanguard:** A high-mobility kinetic assault platform featuring articulated dorsal locking collars, calf-to-spine inertial balance nodes, and micro-servo shock mounts built to catch, wield, and redirect the tremendous torque of a morphing multi-segment kinetic Board.
- **The Weaver:** An advanced molecular fabrication chassis centered around thoracic titanium-ceramic reservoirs housing millions of microscopic alloy nanites, governed by high-frequency magnetic confinement conduits and fluid-fabric kinetic shrouds.

## 5. NEURO-PHYSICAL INVARIANTS

### SINGLE ACTIVE CHASSIS LIMIT (SYNAPTIC SATURATION)

Because the Neural Control Chip establishes a comprehensive bidirectional map between the operative's motor cortex, autonomic nervous system, and suit telemetry, the biological brain can only sustain **one active chassis mapping at a time**.

Attempting to cross-link or equip multiple MANTLE frames simultaneously causes immediate sensory confusion and neurological overload—a life-threatening condition known as **Synaptic Burnout** that results in violent motor seizures, cardiovascular shock, and permanent neural scarring. Consequently, an operative can have **only one MANTLE chassis equipped and active at any time**.

### CLASS ATTRIBUTES & STARTING CREATION

Every MANTLE chassis is governed by **three specialized Class Attributes** (e.g., *Flame, Frost, Lightning* for the Conduit; *Venom, Hazard, Serum* for the Hazard; *Power, Speed, Precision* for the Pilot).

- **Starting Values:** All three Class Attributes begin at a baseline of **1** (`1 / 1 / 1`).
- **Creation Budget:** At character creation, spend **7 Class Creation Points** across your three Class Attributes.
- **Point Costs:** Increasing an Attribute from 1 to 4 costs **1 point** per step; raising an Attribute from 4 to 5 costs **2 points**. Maximum starting rating is **5**.

### DOWNTIME ACQUISITION & SWAPPING (100,000 CR)

Operatives are not locked into a single chassis for their entire career. During campaign downtime, an operative can purchase an additional bespoke MANTLE chassis for **100,000 Credits**.

This substantial investment reflects the true cost of acquiring an aerospace-grade military frame on the open or grey market, purchasing proprietary firmware licenses or black-market decryption keys, and spending an extended shift in an orbital cyber-clinic to undergo neuro-pod recalibration. During recalibration, the operative's NCC is flushed and flashed with the telemetry profiles of the new frame, preventing synaptic rejection.

**Preserved Investment:** Attribute ratings, unlocked ability packages, and purchased class mods belong permanently to each specific chassis. When an operative spends downtime swapping from their Conduit MANTLE to their Vanguard MANTLE in the ship's armory, their Vanguard attributes and unlocked combos remain exactly as they left them.

# CLASS: THE CONDUIT

**The Conduit is the cell's living capacitor and high-intensity shock trooper, defined by total neuro-synaptic integration with a specialized Conduit-pattern MANTLE (*Modular Adaptive Neural Transmission Linked Equipment*). Controlled directly through the operative's permanent Neural Control Chip (NCC) and cranial shunt, the rig synchronizes layered graphene-dielectric capacitor plates and a dense network of subdermal energy conduits mounted along the operative's spine and major limb axes. Translucent fluoropolymer conduits trace along the limbs and torso, glowing with sharp chromatic pulses—radiant amber, sub-zero cerulean, or electric violet—that correspond to their current electromagnetic and thermal saturation. Thermoelectric Peltier arrays and micro-vent heat sinks embedded across the shoulders continuously dissipate ambient thermal bleed, surrounding the Conduit in a shimmering haze of superheated air, drifting ice vapor, or crackling static discharge.**

In active combat, the Conduit operates under hard-science principles of rapid energy accumulation, capacitive storage, and directed discharge. Rather than relying on external power cells, the operative's internal plates draw kinetic recoil, thermal friction, and metabolic potential, converting them into a high-density internal charge. As these capacitor banks saturate through tactical Amp maneuvers, the Conduit channels this power into devastating physical and technical feats—accelerating muscle contraction for near-instant bounds, flash-freezing deckplates, or discharging high-voltage arcs across enemy formations. Yet this stored power creates immense systemic tension: holding peak voltage strains internal insulation and elevates core temperatures, demanding that the operative periodically vent their fully saturated plates in catastrophic, encounter-shifting Burst releases.

The modular versatility of the Conduit MANTLE chassis makes them an invaluable asset across every operational theater. An operative can tune their capacitor discharge to deliver high-yield explosive breaching charges and searing thermal barrages to crack armored strongpoints, flash-freeze corridors into impenetrable crystalline barricades to secure a defensive retreat, or defibrillate flatlined cell members with calibrated neuro-electric pulses during frantic firefights. When technical systems fail, the Conduit can overcharge friendly electronics, fabricate temporary tactical gear from polarized plate residue, or surge bodily across the battlefield to dismantle enemy squads. Whatever the mission requires, the Conduit controls the flow of battlefield energy.

## ATTRIBUTES

A Conduit's capabilities are governed by three specialized Class Attributes:

- **Flame:** The generation and vectoring of high-thermal incendiary blasts, concussive pressure waves, and kinetic combustion.
- **Frost:** The rapid endothermic extraction of heat, cryogenic crystallization, and molecular structural stabilization.
- **Lightning:** The accumulation and discharge of high-voltage galvanic arcs, electromagnetic pulses, and synaptic acceleration.

At character creation, distribute **7 Class Creation Points** across your Flame, Frost, and Lightning Attributes (baseline 1 / 1 / 1). Raising an Attribute from 1 to 4 costs 1 point per increase; raising an Attribute from 4 to 5 costs 2 points. The maximum starting rating for any Class Attribute is **5**.

## BASIC MECHANICS

### MINOR TOUCH EFFECTS

Even without a test, you can channel low-voltage currents, focused heat, or endothermic siphons through your bare hands to produce minor narrative effects:

- **Flame:** Warm an object, ignite a pilot light or fuse, dry wet fabric, thaw thin frost, or cauterize a minor surface abrasion.
- **Frost:** Chill a beverage, flash-freeze standing water, solidify a viscous chemical puddle, or soothe a localized burn.
- **Lightning:** Deliver a mild static shock, illuminate a low-voltage LED indicator, ground static interference on a console, or clear visual distortion from a monitor.

### MELEE COMBAT

You can channel raw elemental energy through your fists, limbs, and close-quarters weapons, making melee attacks using your Conduit Attributes paired with their corresponding physical Core Attributes:

- **Flame (Thermal / Incendiary):** Favored pair **Flame + Strength**. Unleash concussive kinetic blasts and searing thermal strikes, directing explosive force with muscular might.
- **Frost (Cryogenic Piercing):** Favored pair **Frost + Finesse**. Wield and drive crystalline ice daggers into structural seams and joint seals with pinpoint precision.
- **Lightning (Galvanic Arc):** Favored pair **Lightning + Agility**. Blitz opponents with high-voltage arcing strikes and rapid-fire blows, using electrical potential to augment raw speed.
- **Favored Pair Damage Bonus:** When you make a melee attack using the weapon's favored Attribute Pair, you gain a damage bonus equal to the **lower attribute** in that pair.

### EFFECT SYNERGIES

Channeling specific elemental frequencies through your Conduit Attributes enhances the potency of standard tactical Effects:

- **Flame:** When taking a test that uses your Flame attribute, your **Crit Effects** grant **3 Success Points** instead of the standard 2 per Hit sacrificed.
- **Frost:** When taking a test that uses your Frost attribute, any **Blocker Effects** or **Downgrade Effects** you establish become **Sustained Effects** until the end of the round, resetting after each affected attempt until overcome or cleared.
- **Lightning:** When taking a test that uses your Lightning attribute, your **Chain Effects** also increase your total **Success Points by +1**, and you can spend any dice that rolled **7 or higher** to activate them instead of the normal 8 or higher.

## THE CHARGE ENGINE

Conduit abilities revolve around the dynamic accumulation and venting of **Charges** held within your subcutaneous capacitor plates:

- **Capacity & Starting State:** Your capacitor plates can hold a maximum of **3 Charges**. You begin every combat encounter at **0 Charges**.
- **Amp Abilities (Charge Generators):**
  - Amp abilities channel raw energy into your plates, building up elemental Charge while delivering immediate tactical advantages.
  - Activating an Amp ability with 0 Charges grants you **1 Charge** of that ability's element type.
  - Activating an Amp ability of the *same* element as your current Charges increases your stored **Charges by 1** (up to the maximum of 3 Charges).
  - Activating an Amp ability of a *different* element than your current Charges immediately resets your stored Charges to 0 before granting 1 Charge of the new element (unless modified by Class Mods).
  - You cannot activate an Amp ability if you already hold the maximum of 3 Charges for that element (unless modified by *Infinity*).
  - You can only activate a single Amp ability per action.
- **Burst Abilities (Charge Venters):**
  - Burst abilities vent your fully saturated capacitor plates in devastating, encounter-defining releases.
  - Burst abilities can only be activated when you hold **exactly 3 Charges** (unless modified by *Finality*).
  - You can only activate the Burst variant corresponding to your currently stored elemental Charge.
  - Activating a Burst ability consumes and vents **all 3 Charges**, resetting your stored Charges to 0.

## CLASS ABILITIES

Conduit abilities are organized into **7 thematic packages**, each featuring a paired **Amp Ability** and **Burst Ability** with distinct Flame, Frost, and Lightning branches. Operatives select **1 starting package** at character creation, and unlock **1 additional package** at Levels 2, 3, and 4.

Every ability explicitly declares its **Action Economy Tag**:

- **[Rider]:** Costs **0 additional AP**; enhances or triggers during an existing action (such as a firearm attack, melee strike, or movement action).
- **[Reaction]:** Costs **0 AP**; triggered in response to an external event (such as being targeted by an incoming attack). Limited to once per turn unless noted.
- **[Action]:** Costs **1 AP**; requires rolling a test or deploying an immediate tactical effect.

### 1. RANGED PACKAGE

The Ranged Package integrates subcutaneous capacitor lines directly with chambered ammunition and ballistic rails, infusing firearm projectiles with elemental payload before venting residual energy in devastating area bombardments.

**Amped Shot [Rider]**

- **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Trigger:** When declaring a ranged attack with a Firearm.
- **Effect:** *Capacitor shunts bleed raw energy directly into the chambered round as the firing pin strikes.* You gain **+1 Charge** of the chosen element and apply the matching effect to the attack:
  - **Flame:** Ranged attacks deal a flat **+1 Damage Bonus per active Charge** (including the Charge just gained) as superheated thermal jackets detonate on impact.
  - **Frost:** You may reroll a number of dice across all rolls in the test equal to your **active Charges** (including the Charge just gained), freezing your targeting reticle onto structural weak points.
  - **Lightning:** When activating your first **Chain Effect** during the attack test, you can target a number of additional creatures equal to your **active Charges** (including the Charge just gained) without expending additional ammunition.

**Blast Burst [Action]**

- **Resource Cost:** Requires and consumes 3 Charges
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Capacitor plates vent their entire reserve through external projector nozzles in a catastrophic ranged detonation.* Target a space within **Short range (0–5 spaces)** and make a **Conduit Success Test** using the attribute matching your consumed Charges:
  - **Flame:** Searing incendiary blast waves scour the impact zone. You inflict thermal damage equal to your **Success Points + your Flame Attribute** to every creature occupying an **8-meter radius** centered on the target space.
  - **Frost:** A pressurized cryogenic shockwave flash-freezes the atmosphere. You inflict cryogenic damage equal to your **Success Points + your Frost Attribute** to every creature caught in a **90-degree cone, 12 meters long**, originating from your space. In addition, every space caught within the cone becomes **Difficult Terrain** until the end of the round.
  - **Lightning:** A piercing bolt of stepped-leader plasma lances forward. You inflict galvanic damage equal to your **Success Points + your Lightning Attribute** to up to **three chosen creatures** in your space, the target space, or any space intersecting the straight line of fire between them. You can activate **Chain Effects** on this roll to increase the number of targets.

## 2. MELEE PACKAGE

The Melee Package routes high-density capacitor currents directly through forearm plates and knuckles, supercharging physical strikes with kinetic backblast before venting in an earth-shattering point-blank impact.

**Amped Strike [Rider]**

- **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Trigger:** When declaring a melee attack or elemental melee strike.
- **Effect:** *Subdermal conduits flash with kinetic energy, amplifying close-quarters impact.* You gain **+1 Charge** of the chosen element and apply the matching effect to the strike:
  - **Flame:** Thermal backblast detonates on contact. The attack deals a flat **+1 Damage Bonus per active Charge** (including the Charge just gained), or you may spend your strike's momentum to **Push** the target 1 space (2 meters) per active Charge.
  - **Frost:** Sub-zero frost coats the target's limbs and servos. For each **active Charge** you hold (including the Charge just gained), apply **1 standard Downgrade** to the target's physical tests until the end of the round.
  - **Lightning:** High-voltage static leaps between targets. If the attack hits, you can chain the strike to **1 additional adjacent enemy per active Charge** (including the Charge just gained) without sacrificing Hits.

**Impact Burst [Action]**

- **Resource Cost:** Requires and consumes 3 Charges
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *All capacitor banks vent simultaneously through your striking limb, detonating a point-blank kinetic catastrophe.* Target a creature or reinforced structure in your space or an adjacent space and make a **Conduit Success Test** using the attribute matching your consumed Charges:
  - **Flame (Inferno Impact):** You deliver an explosive punch that inflicts massive thermal damage equal to your **Success Points + your Flame Attribute + 4 bonus damage** to the primary target. In addition, an outward shockwave inflicts damage equal to your **Flame Attribute** to all other hostile creatures in your space and adjacent spaces.
  - **Frost (Glacial Impact):** You drive a flash-freezing spike of solid ice into the target, inflicting damage equal to your **Success Points + your Frost Attribute** and encasing them in dense crystalline frost. This establishes a **Blocker Effect of 3 dice** against all physical and movement actions attempted by the target until the ice is shattered or cleared.
  - **Lightning (Thunder Impact):** A devastating galvanic arc vaporizes air between you and the target, inflicting damage equal to your **Success Points + your Lightning Attribute**. You instantly arc-discharge through the target, reappearing in any unoccupied space up to **8 meters away**; all hostile creatures caught in the line between your starting space and destination take damage equal to your **Lightning Attribute**.

## 3. MOBILITY PACKAGE

The Mobility Package siphons stored energy into myofibril micro-servos and personal propulsion vents, converting raw electrical and thermal voltage into blinding battlefield traversal.

**Amped Sprint [Rider]**

- **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Trigger:** When declaring a Movement Action.
- **Effect:** *Internal capacitor loops flood motor pathways and directional thrusters with accelerated voltage.* You gain **+1 Charge** of the chosen element and execute your movement with enhanced parameters scaling with your **active Charges** (including the Charge just gained):
  - **Flame:** Vector thrusters ignite with thermal fury. You gain **+2 meters of movement per active Charge**, and you may **Fly** for the duration of this movement action.
  - **Frost:** Frictionless cryogenic frost glazes the deck beneath your boots. You gain **+2 meters of movement per active Charge**, ignore Difficult Terrain, and leave a trail of **Difficult Terrain** behind you through every space traversed (persisting until the end of the round).
  - **Lightning:** Hyper-accelerated neuro-muscular reflexes twitch at microsecond speeds. You gain **+2 meters of movement per active Charge**, and your movement is **completely uncontested** (it cannot trigger reactions, intercept fire, or blocker effects).

**Motion Burst [Action]**

- **Resource Cost:** Requires and consumes 3 Charges
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *You dump all three capacitor banks into full-body acceleration, executing a supersonic blitz across the battlefield.* You move a number of meters equal to your **active Conduit Attribute × 4**, followed immediately by an elemental impact or tactical release:
  - **Flame:** You fly at extreme velocity directly into a hostile target's space. All creatures occupying your destination space suffer thermal collision damage equal to your **Flame Attribute + your Strength Attribute**.
  - **Frost:** You skate across the engagement zone, turning every space traversed into **Difficult Terrain** for enemies. In your final destination space, you instantly manifest a jagged wall of reinforced ice that acts as **Medium Cover (Cover Rating 2, 24 HP, Innate Protection 8)**.
  - **Lightning:** You blitz across the battlefield with blinding speed, making an elemental melee attack against a creature along your path (inflicting standard melee damage + your Lightning Attribute). You may use any remaining movement after the attack to disengage freely. Furthermore, you can activate **Chain Effects** on this attack against **any creature in any space you traversed** during this movement.

## 4. DEFENSE PACKAGE

The Defense Package channels stored capacitive reserves into reactive dispersion meshes, endothermic kinetic barriers, and high-frequency deflector fields to nullify incoming assaults.

**Amped Defense [Reaction]**

- **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Trigger:** Once per turn, when you are targeted by an incoming attack.
- **Effect:** *Reactive capacitor circuits discharge defensively before the incoming strike lands.* You gain **+1 Charge** of the chosen element and apply the matching defensive protection scaling with your **active Charges** (including the Charge just gained):
  - **Flame:** Thermal flare vents outward. If the attacker occupies your space or an adjacent space, they immediately take thermal counter-damage equal to your **Flame Attribute + your active Charges**.
  - **Frost:** Endothermic plates flash-freeze ambient moisture across your torso. You gain **+1 Physical Protection per active Charge** against this incoming attack.
  - **Lightning:** An electrostatic distortion field crackles around your chassis. If you contest the incoming attack, you gain a number of **Upgrades to the Contest Roll equal to your active Charges** (including the Charge just gained).

**Shield Burst [Reaction]**

- **Resource Cost:** Requires and consumes 3 Charges
- **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Trigger:** When you or an ally in your space are targeted by an incoming attack.
- **Effect:** *You dump your entire capacitor reserve in an emergency defensive surge, contesting the incoming attack for free (0 AP) using your active Conduit Attribute:*
  - **Flame:** A concussive thermal explosion engulfs your perimeter. All creatures other than you in your space take damage equal to **Flame Attribute + Your Conduit Level**.
  - **Frost:** A reinforced crystalline ice cocoon locks across your position. You may create **Medium Cover** in your current space.
  - **Lightning:** You dodge the attack with immense speed. You can move a number of meters equal to your highest die plus your **Lightning Attribute**.

## 5. RESTORATION PACKAGE

The Restoration Package routes delicate micro-currents and regulated thermal gradients through cardiovascular pathways, stimulating cellular mitosis, stabilizing shock, and defibrillating flatlined allies.

**Amped Regen [Action]**

- **Cost:** 1 AP (0 AP if activated as a Reaction via Lightning)
- **Trigger:** Once per Player Turn, as long as you have Light Wounds (or Light Stress in the case of Frost), or immediately after taking damage if using Lightning.
- **Effect:** *Precision bio-electric currents stimulate rapid cellular granulation and synaptic stabilization.* You gain **+1 Charge** of the chosen element and heal **Light Wounds equal to your active Charges** (including the Charge just gained). In addition:
  - **Flame:** Searing thermal cauterization closes hemorrhaging instantly; heal **+1 additional Light Wound** (healing total Light Wounds equal to your **active Charges + 1**).
  - **Frost:** Endothermic biogel soothes trauma; you may choose to heal either **Light Wounds** or **Light Stress**.
  - **Lightning:** Galvanic defibrillation triggers on instinct; this ability can be activated as a **Reaction (0 AP) immediately after taking damage**, but if activated in this way, you cannot activate Amped Regen on your next Player Turn.

**Healing Burst [Free Action]**

- **Resource Cost:** Requires and consumes 3 Charges
- **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Target:** You or a single ally occupying your current space.
- **Effect:** *Your plates release a massive metabolic and neuro-electrical surge to reconstruct damaged tissue, supercharge adrenaline, and restart stopped hearts.* The chosen target heals **Light Wounds or Light Stress** (recipient's choice) equal to your **chosen elemental Attribute + your Willpower or Toughness** (your choice). In addition, based on the element consumed:
  - **Flame:** Searing thermal stimulation and metabolic overdrive stoke fiery vigor; the target gains **+1 Upgrade** on all **Strength** and **Presence** tests for the rest of the round.
  - **Frost:** Endothermic crystalline biogel flash-freezes across vitals; the target gains **+1 Upgrade** on all **Finesse** tests for the rest of the round, and gains **+4 Protection** against the next attack targeting the recipient that would hit.
  - **Lightning:** Galvanic cardiac-synaptic resuscitation surges through reflexes; the target gains **+1 Upgrade** on all **Agility** tests for the rest of the round, and this ability can resurrect the target if they died during the current round, immediately reviving them to consciousness with their healed Light Wounds.

## 6. PROWESS PACKAGE

The Prowess Package bridges internal capacitor storage with everyday physical, mental, and sensory operations, channeling elemental reserves into non-combat challenges, investigations, and technical feats.

**Amped Prowess [Action]**

- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Restriction:** Strictly for non-combat, narrative, and downtime challenges (cannot be used during combat rounds).
- **Effect:** *Internal energy reservoirs focus body, mind, or senses into effortless mastery.* You gain **+1 Charge** of the chosen element and make a non-combat test using an attribute matching your element, gaining **Upgrades equal to your active Charges** (including the Charge just gained):
  - **Flame:** Channel thermal combustion into athletic feats, heavy labor, physical intimidation, or commanding social presence (tests using **Strength** or **Presence**).
  - **Frost:** Channel endothermic calm into micro-manipulation, technical repair, hacking, forensic investigation, or surgery (tests using **Finesse** or **Knowledge**).
  - **Lightning:** Channel galvanic reflexes into navigation, stealth, environmental awareness, or rapid zero-g traversal (tests using **Agility** or **Instinct**).

**Overdrive Burst [Action]**

- **Resource Cost:** Requires and consumes 3 Charges
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *You dump all three capacitor banks into an overwhelming surge of biological, analytical, or sensory hyper-performance.* When taking any test that includes an attribute matching your consumed Charges (Flame: **Strength / Presence**; Frost: **Finesse / Knowledge**; Lightning: **Agility / Instinct**) that is **not an attack action** (usable in or outside of combat):
  - You set up to **3 dice in your Success Roll to their maximum possible face value** (10 on a d10, 12 on a d12).
  - These maximum-value dice can be banked for **Gambit Points**, sacrificed for **Hits** and **Crit Effects**, or kept to guarantee extraordinary Success Points.

## 7. GEAR SYNTHESIS PACKAGE

The Gear Synthesis Package links capacitor output directly with field equipment, boosting active hardware with elemental frequencies or condensing energy into short-lived physical munitions, barriers, and electronic rigs.

**Amp Gear [Rider / Action]**

- **Cost:** 0 AP as a Rider when utilizing eligible gear, or 1 AP as an Action to calibrate gear.
- **Effect:** *Capacitor shunts couple directly into handheld tools, weapons, and devices.* You gain **+1 Charge** of the chosen element and select one of two calibration options corresponding to your element:
  - **Flame (Strength-Linked Gear):** *Thermal Striker:* Equipped melee weapon gains a flat **+1 Damage Bonus per active Charge** until end of round. *Pyrotechnic Fuse:* On Ordnance tests, dice equal to your active Charges score **Crit Effects on 7+** instead of 8+.
  - **Frost (Finesse-Linked Gear):** *Cryo Calibrator:* When performing tests requiring Finesse gear, reroll dice equal to your active Charges. *Endothermic Coagulant:* Medical items gain bonus **Success Points equal to active Charges**.
  - **Lightning (Agility-Linked Gear):** *Vector Supercharger:* Mobility equipment gains **Upgrades equal to active Charges**. *Conductive ICE-Breaker:* Hacking or Interfacing tests gain **Upgrades equal to active Charges**.

**Synthesis Burst [Action]**

- **Resource Cost:** Requires and consumes 3 Charges
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Condense high-density energy into single-use hardware (Load 0, lasts one activation or until encounter ends):*
  - **Flame:** *Thermal Grenade:* Frag or HE grenade with **Ordnance equal to Flame**. *Vectored Jump-Rig:* Jetpack with **Mobility equal to Flame** (grants 1 flight move).
  - **Frost:** *Cryo Trauma Kit:* Field Medi-Kit with **Medicine equal to Frost**. *Glacial Barricade:* Medium Deployable Cover (**+2 Cover, 24 HP, Protection 8**) in your space.
  - **Lightning:** *Arc Flashbang:* Flashbang with **Ordnance equal to Lightning** (Stun, 4m radius). *Virtual Cyberdeck:* Cyberdeck with **Hacking/Interfacing equal to Lightning**.

## CLASS MODS

Class Mods represent advanced dielectric overclocks and firmware overrides installed directly into the Conduit's chassis. The Conduit has access to **5 distinct Class Mods** (25,000 Credits each, socketed at Levels 3 and 5, max 2 active):

- **1. Duality:** You can store Charges of **two different elements simultaneously** (maximum 3 Charges shared). Burst consumes all stored charges, venting the majority element (your choice if split).
- **2. Infinity:** Continue activating Amp abilities even when holding **maximum 3 Charges**. Resolves active mechanical effects while stored Charges remain capped at 3 without resetting.
- **3. Intensity:** Whenever scoring a **Hit (8+)** on any test using Conduit Attributes, sacrifice that Hit to **generate 1 Charge** of that element type (up to max capacity).
- **4. Finality:** Activate Burst abilities with **fewer than 3 Charges** (even at 0 Charges). Consumes all charges; you **cannot gain Charges of any element until end of round**.
- **5. Ingenuity:** Activating an Amp of a different element does not reset charges; choose to **convert all existing Charges into the new element type** and increase by +1.

## PROGRESSION

The Conduit chassis can be upgraded at specialized cybernetic armories and neuro-clinics by spending Credits during downtime. Each upgrade level expands attribute capacity, unlocks advanced ability packages, and opens hardware Mod slots. At character creation, distribute **7 Class Creation Points** among Flame, Frost, and Lightning (base 1 / 1 / 1, starting cap 5). You begin with **1 Ability Package** of your choice.

**CONDUIT CHASSIS PROGRESSION (LEVELS 1-5)**

| LEVEL | BENEFITS UNLOCKED | CREDIT COST |
|---|---|---|
| Level 1 | Base Chassis, 7 Attribute Points (base 1/1/1), Starting Package (Amp & Burst), Charge Engine (Max 3) | **100,000 Credits*** |
| Level 2 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Ability Package | **20,000 Credits** |
| Level 3 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Class Mod Slot (Slot 1), +1 Ability Package | **40,000 Credits** |
| Level 4 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Ability Package | **75,000 Credits** |
| Level 5 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Class Mod Slot (Slot 2) | **150,000 Credits** |

**The 100,000 Credit cost for Level 1 applies only when purchasing an additional class chassis after character creation; an operative's starting class chassis is free.*

### TACTICAL CONDUIT ARCHETYPES

- **The Pyromancer Breacher:** Maximizes *Flame* paired with Strength and Melee/Ranged. Uses Amped strikes to shatter barricades, venting Inferno Impacts to wipe enemy assault squads.
- **The Cryo Sentinel:** Prioritizes *Frost* paired with Finesse and Defense/Mobility. Freezes hostile corridors, locks down heavy threats in crystalline ice, and protects allies with reactive armor.
- **The Galvanic Blitz:** Combines high *Lightning* with Agility and Mobility. Chains high-voltage arcs through multiple enemies at once, blitzing across the battlefield without provoking intercept fire.
- **The Field Resuscitator:** Invests in Restoration, balancing Frost biogels with Lightning defibrillation to heal wounds, soothe stress, and revive fallen allies mid-firefight.

# CLASS: THE HAZARD

**The Hazard is the cell's combat alchemist and chemical warfare specialist, defined by their neural synchronization with a specialized Hazard-pattern MANTLE (*Modular Adaptive Neural Transmission Linked Equipment*) and its pressurized ChemPack manifold. Controlled directly through the operative's permanent Neural Control Chip (NCC) and cervical shunt, the rig coordinates an intricate network of reinforced subcutaneous fluid lines and an armored dorsal harness. Mounted between the operative's shoulder blades, the Catalyst Chamber houses high-pressure reaction vessels, micro-solenoid valves, and high-frequency acoustic mixers that synthesize complex biochemical compounds in fractions of a second. Translucent fluoropolymer conduits trace along the operative's arms and torso, pulsing rhythmically with luminous reagents as transdermal dermojets and wrist-mounted atomizers prepare volatile mixtures for instant deployment. Often seen wearing a low-profile negative-pressure respirator to withstand their own toxic microclimates, the Hazard operates in an unmistakable aura of ozone, sharp ether, and metallic vapor.**

In active combat, the ChemPack functions under principles of rapid binary synthesis and extreme hydraulic pressure. Rather than hauling bulk quantities of unstable compounds, the Hazard stores stabilized base reagents in three hermetic reservoirs, combining them within the central Catalyst Chamber only at the moment of discharge. This internal pressure dictates the potency of every brew: as the operative redlines the chamber, internal atomizers produce hyper-reactive mists, searing incendiaries, and accelerated stimulant cocktails. Yet this power demands disciplined regulation. Pushing the Catalyst Chamber beyond its mechanical tolerance risks catastrophic blowout, violently rupturing safety gaskets and spewing caustic backwash across the operative's own chassis.

The modular versatility of the Hazard MANTLE chassis makes them an indispensable tactical pivot across all combat scenarios. In heavy firefights, the operative can lay down blinding aerosol screens and adhesive polymer barriers to disrupt enemy advances, dissolve armored bulkheads with hyper-reactive acids, or detonate thermal blasts that scour entrenched firing nests. When cell members fall under heavy fire, the Hazard shifts immediately from biohazard offensive to frontline triage, injecting neuro-metabolic stimulants to restore spent action potential, dosing wounded allies with coagulant biogels, or shocking flatlined comrades back to consciousness. Whatever the operational theater demands, the Hazard controls the biochemical battlefield.

## ATTRIBUTES

A Hazard's capabilities are governed by three specialized Class Attributes:

- **Venom:** The synthesis and delivery of debilitating neurotoxins, systemic bio-agents, and corrosive acids that degrade enemy resilience from within.
- **Hazard:** The compounding and detonation of volatile, hypergolic, and thermal reagents engineered to deliver catastrophic concussive force on impact.
- **Serum:** The precision compounding and rapid administration of restorative bio-gels, clotting coagulants, and cellular metabolic stimulants.

At character creation, distribute **7 Class Creation Points** across your Venom, Hazard, and Serum Attributes (baseline 1 / 1 / 1). Raising an Attribute from 1 to 4 costs 1 point per increase; raising an Attribute from 4 to 5 costs 2 points. The maximum starting rating for any Class Attribute is **5**.

## BASIC MECHANICS

### THE CATALYST CHAMBER & PRESSURE ENGINE

The Hazard's abilities are powered by the internal pressure of their ChemPack's Catalyst Chamber. Internal pressure dictates chemical atomization velocity, mixture density, and overall potency:

- **Pressure Range:** Chamber Pressure is measured on a scale from **0 to 3**. Operatives begin every combat encounter at **Pressure 0**.
- **The Volatile Die:** As chamber pressure climbs, internal agitation supercharges your tests with an additional **Volatile Die**. The size of the Volatile Die corresponds directly to your current Pressure:
  - **Pressure 0:** No Volatile Die.
  - **Pressure 1: d8** Volatile Die.
  - **Pressure 2: d10** Volatile Die.
  - **Pressure 3: d12** Volatile Die.
- **Inherent Volatility:** Whenever Pressure is **1 or higher**, rolling your active Volatile Die is **mandatory** on all tests using Hazard Attributes. The Volatile Die cannot be stepped up, stepped down, or modified by standard Upgrades or Downgrades.
- **Test Pool Integration:** In Simple and Success Tests, roll the Volatile Die alongside your standard test pool. In Complex Tests, the Volatile Die is added to your Action Roll pool; if selected as one of your kept dice during the Success Roll, its face value determines your Success Points as normal.

### RUPTURE RESOLUTION (CHAMBER BLOWOUT)

Pushing the Catalyst Chamber to high pressure offers immense tactical reward, but risks catastrophic mechanical failure:

- **Triggering a Rupture:** Whenever the Volatile Die rolls a **Hit (8 or higher)** on any test, a **Rupture** occurs immediately.
- **The Hit Counts:** The Hit rolled on the Volatile Die is valid and contributes to the success of your action, Success Points, or Hit-spending effects as normal.
- **Blowout Consequence:** The chamber's emergency pressure seals blow out under the stress. You immediately suffer **2 Light Wounds** (bypassing Physical Protection) and your Chamber Pressure **instantly vents to 0**.

### REGULATE CHAMBER [ACTION]

To ensure you never become tactically deadlocked when your active abilities require specific pressure conditions, you can manually modulate the Catalyst Chamber's valves:

- **Action Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** You manually cycle the ChemPack's pneumatic purge valves or stroke the primer pump. Choose one of the following:
  - **Pump:** Increase Chamber Pressure by **+1** (to a maximum of Pressure 3).
  - **Vent:** Decrease Chamber Pressure by **-1** (to a minimum of Pressure 0).

### BASELINE ATTRIBUTE ACTIONS

Every Hazard Attribute provides a baseline combat application that can be executed without unlocking specific ability kits. Each baseline action costs **1 AP** and standardizes around spending rolled **Hits**:

- **Venom — Debilitating Dose [Action]:** Administer a debilitating dose against a creature in your space or an adjacent space (which can be delivered as a melee strike or applied **covertly**, such as a subtle touch or concealed contact), rolling a **Venom Success Test**. For each **Hit** you sacrifice from the roll, apply **1 Downgrade** to that creature. This Downgrade is permanent until treated or removed. A creature can be affected by only one of your Venom Downgrades at a time, and you can maintain a maximum number of active Venom Downgrades equal to your **Venom** Attribute rating.
- **Hazard — Explosive Strike [Action]:** Make a melee attack using your **Hazard** Attribute to detonate a pressurized binary charge against a target in your space or an adjacent space. This attack deals your standard melee striking damage plus **bonus damage equal to your Hazard Attribute rating** (and you can spend Hits on effects as normal).
- **Serum — Performance Dose [Action]:** Administer a fast-acting metabolic cocktail to yourself or a willing creature in your space or an adjacent space, rolling a **Serum Success Test**. When administered, bind the dose to a specific **Core Attribute** (Strength, Agility, Finesse, Knowledge, Presence, or Instinct). For each **Hit** you sacrifice from the roll, apply **1 Upgrade** that triggers specifically on tests using that chosen Attribute. This Upgrade is permanent until removed or expended. A creature can benefit from only one of your Serum Upgrades at a time, and you can maintain a maximum number of active Serum Upgrades equal to your **Serum** Attribute rating.

## CLASS ABILITIES

Hazard abilities are grouped into specialized **Kits**, each containing three synergized chemical techniques. Operatives select **1 starting Kit** at character creation, and unlock **1 additional Kit** at Levels 2, 3, and 4.

Every ability explicitly specifies its **Pressure Cost/Change** and **Action Economy Tag**:

- If an ability's Pressure change would cause your Pressure to exceed **3** or drop below **0**, that ability **cannot be used** (unless modified by hardware such as the *Redline Engine*).

### MEDIC KIT

The Medic Kit packages rapid-clotting bio-foams, transdermal tissue reconstructors, and defibrillating micro-currents for frontline surgical stabilization.

#### First Aid [Action]

- **Attribute:** Serum | **Pressure:** `-1 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Pressurized bio-gel seals lacerations and stabilizes hemorrhaging flesh.* Target yourself or a creature in your space or an adjacent space and make a **Serum Success Test**. For every 2 Success Points, heal **1 Light Wound** on the target. In addition, heal a flat number of extra Light Wounds equal to your current **Pressure** level.

#### Regenerator [Action]

- **Attribute:** Serum | **Pressure:** `-1 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Neuro-calming biogels soothe frayed synapses and alleviate cognitive overload.* Target yourself or a creature in your space or an adjacent space and make a **Serum Success Test**. For every 2 Success Points, heal **1 Light Stress** (Mental Wound) on the target. In addition, heal a flat number of extra Light Stress equal to your current **Pressure** level.

#### Defibrillator [Action]

- **Attribute:** Serum / Hazard | **Pressure:** `+2 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A high-voltage chemical electrode discharges either restorative stimulus or lethal concussive shock.* Target a creature in your space or an adjacent space:
  - **Unconscious Target (Serum):** Make a **Serum Success Test**. For every 2 Success Points, heal **1 Light Wound**. In addition, if your Pressure is at least 1, heal **1 Aggravated Wound**.
  - **Conscious Enemy (Hazard):** Make a melee attack using **Hazard**. The attack deals standard melee damage plus bonus damage equal to your current **Pressure** level.

## BOOSTER KIT

The Booster Kit delivers aggressive neuro-stimulants, respiratory dilators, and muscular overclocks to shatter biological limits under fire.

**Micro-Booster [Rider]**

- **Pressure:** `+1 Pressure` | **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Trigger:** When you or an ally in your space or an adjacent space declare an action.
- **Effect:** *A pressurized transdermal jet releases a micro-dose of hyper-stimulant into the bloodstream.* Add your active **Volatile Die** to all rolls involved in the declared action's test. If the Volatile Die rolls a Hit (8+), it triggers a Rupture on your ChemPack as normal.

**Maximum Effort [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Serum | **Pressure:** `-2 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Adrenal superchargers flood motor neurons, amplifying raw physical output.* Roll a **Serum Simple Test**. For each **Hit** you sacrifice, grant **+1 Upgrade** to all physical tests made by a creature in your space or an adjacent space until the end of the round.

**Adrenaline Rush [Free Action]**

- **Attribute:** Serum | **Pressure:** `-3 Pressure` | **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Effect:** *An emergency surge of neuro-stimulants accelerates synaptic transmission to hyper-reflexive speeds.* Target yourself or an ally in your space or an adjacent space. The next action taken by the target does not count against the Player Turn limit.

## POISON KIT

The Poison Kit synthesizes necrotic toxins, respiratory agents, and systemic catalysts that break down biological structures over sustained engagements.

**Envenom [Rider]**

- **Attribute:** Venom | **Pressure:** `+1 Pressure` | **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Trigger:** When you declare a melee strike (against a target in your space or an adjacent space) or fire a weapon at Short range.
- **Effect:** *Pneumatic conduits coat your weapon edge or ammunition jacket in virulent neurotoxin.* The attack gains **+1 bonus damage per Pressure level**. Additionally, you may sacrifice **Hits** rolled on the attack to apply **1 Venom Downgrade per Hit** to the target (subject to your active Venom limit).

**Decay [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Venom | **Pressure:** `-3 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A resonant acoustic pulse or catalytic compound triggers violent cellular breakdown in previously dosed targets.* Make a **Venom Success Test**. All creatures within Medium range currently suffering from your Venom Downgrades take damage equal to your **Success Points + your Venom Attribute rating**. This action immediately consumes and clears those active Downgrades.

**Cloudkill [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Venom | **Pressure:** `+3 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A pressurized aerosol grenade shatters on impact, releasing a swirling fog of dense, corrosive vapor.* Target a space within **Short range (0–5 spaces)** and make a **Venom Success Test**. For each **Hit** you sacrifice, apply **1 level of a Venom Downgrade** to every creature occupying the target space. The cloud heavily obscures vision into, out of, and through that space until the end of the round.

## PYRO KIT

The Pyro Kit arms the Hazard with hypergolic liquid mixtures and acoustic atomizers that ignite violently upon atmospheric contact.

**Firebolt [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Hazard | **Pressure:** `+1 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A focused pneumatic nozzle hurls a pressurized stream of self-igniting chemical gel.* Make a ranged attack using **Hazard** against a target within **Short range (0–5 spaces)**. The attack inflicts thermal damage equal to your test result plus **+1 bonus damage per Pressure level**.

**Flamestrike [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Hazard | **Pressure:** `+2 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *An explosive aerosol canister detonates overhead, bathing the target zone in clinging liquid fire.* Target a space within **Short range (0–5 spaces)** and make a **Hazard Success Test**. All creatures and flammable structures within the chosen space suffer thermal damage equal to your **Success Points + your current Pressure level**.

**Flame Ward [Reaction]**

- **Attribute:** Hazard | **Pressure:** `-3 Pressure` | **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Trigger:** When you are targeted by an incoming attack.
- **Effect:** *Emergency purge valves vent a concussive thermal flash outward, deflecting the blow and scorching attackers.* Contest the incoming attack for **0 AP**, rolling your contest pool using your **Hazard** Attribute. If the attacker occupies your space or an adjacent space, they immediately take damage equal to the highest die remaining in your contest pool.

## CAUSTIC KIT

The Caustic Kit utilizes hyper-concentrated fluorosulfuric acids and molecular solvents to dissolve inorganic armor plating, vehicle chassis, and structural cover.

**Acid Strike [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Venom
- **Pressure Change:** `+2 Pressure`
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A pressurized burst of fuming acid coats the target, eating away structural seals and composite armor.* Make a melee attack against a creature or object in your space or an adjacent space using **Venom**. For each **Hit** you sacrifice from your roll, you set aside that Hit as an armor-melting effect on the target. You or an ally can expend a set-aside Hit when dealing damage to the target to completely ignore the target's Physical Protection for that instance of damage.

**Caustic Bullets [Rider]**

- **Pressure Change:** `+1 Pressure`
- **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Trigger:** When you declare a ranged attack with a Firearm.
- **Effect:** *Chambered ammunition is coated in high-potency molecular acid jackets prior to firing.* The attack **ignores the target's Physical Protection entirely**. However, the weapon loses any standard flat Damage Bonus it would normally provide for this shot.

**Metal Transfer [Reaction]**

- **Attribute:** Venom
- **Pressure Change:** `-2 Pressure`
- **Cost:** 0 AP
- **Trigger:** When you or an ally in Short range are targeted by an attack or suffer damage.
- **Effect:** *Catalytic bio-conduits siphon dissolved metallic residue from active corrosive agents, instantly flashing a protective metallic film across allied hulls and armor.* Every friendly creature in **Short range (0–5 spaces)** gains **+1 Physical Protection** against the next instance of damage equal to the number of **Hits** you currently have spent and active across your ongoing Venom abilities and Downgrades.

## OOZE KIT

The Ooze Kit synthesizes rapid-curing visco-elastic polymers and non-Newtonian fluids to tether adversaries, restrict limbs, and reshape tactical terrain.

**Rubberband [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Serum
- **Pressure Change:** `+1 Pressure`
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A high-tensile polymer filament launches from your wrist harness at an anchor point or creature within Short range (0–5 spaces / 16 meters):*
  - **Inanimate Anchor & Terrain:** You are immediately winched in a straight line directly to the anchor point.
  - **Hostile Creature:** Roll a **Serum Simple Test**. If you score at least one Hit, the tether latches on; you can spend any **Hits** from the roll to activate **Push Effects** that pull the target creature 1 space (4 meters) directly towards you per Hit spent (spending a single Hit on this Push Effect still counts the action as a success). Following the pull, you may advance along the tether line any number of spaces towards the target (up to entering its space). If you and the target make contact (ending in the same space), you deal collision damage to the target equal to the highest die rolled.

**Slimeball [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Venom
- **Pressure Change:** `-2 Pressure`
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A pressurized globule of heavy, quick-curing resin engulfs the target's extremities.* Make a ranged attack against a target within **Short range (0–5 spaces)** using **Venom**. Instead of dealing damage, sacrifice **Hits** from the roll to establish a **Blocker Effect**:
  - **Locomotion Blocker (Legs/Thrusters):** Negates the target's highest die on movement tests.
  - **Manipulation Blocker (Hands/Weapons):** Negates the target's highest die on weapon attack or manipulation tests.

**Slip and Slide [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Serum
- **Pressure Change:** `-1 Pressure`
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Pressurized nozzles coat deck plates in an ultra-slick surfactant polymer.* Choose a number of adjacent spaces up to your current **Pressure** level (minimum 1 space). Until the start of your next turn, these spaces become **Difficult Terrain** for hostile creatures, and you and your allies gain **+1 Upgrade** on any movement tests made through them.

### SMOKE KIT

The Smoke Kit deploys dense chemical aerosols, thermal-scattering smokescreens, and dual-agent particulate clouds to control visual sightlines and tactical positioning.

**Smoke Screen [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Hazard | **Pressure:** `+2 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Dense micro-particulate smoke scatters visual and IR spectrums.* Roll a **Hazard Simple Test**. For each Hit spent, deploy smoke in one chosen space within Short range. Creatures inside cannot see out, and creatures outside cannot see in/through (2 Downgrades to tests requiring vision). Persists until end of round.

**Gas Canister [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Venom / Serum | **Pressure:** `+2 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Dual-stage aerosol disperses tailored compounds.* Target space within Short range, rolling Venom (applies Venom Downgrade to all enemies) or Serum (applies Serum Upgrade to all allies). Sacrifice 1 Hit to isolate to a single target.

**Gas Turbine [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Hazard | **Pressure:** `-2 Pressure` | **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Pneumatic exhaust turbines cycle high-pressure gas into vectored thrust.* Next movement test rolls using Hazard. You ignore Difficult Terrain, can fly, gain +4 SP per Hit on Crit Effects, and ignore all falling damage until end of round.

## CLASS MODS

Class Mods cost 25,000 Credits each (socketed at Levels 3 and 5, max 2 active):

- **Dart Launcher:** Execute baseline actions (Debilitating Dose, Explosive Strike, Performance Dose) at **Short range (0–5 spaces)** instead of melee reach.
- **Pressure Controls:** Alter an ability's Pressure cost/change by **+1 or -1** (cannot shift positive to negative or vice versa).
- **Critical Rupture:** When Volatile Die rolls a Hit (8+), score the Hit and reroll the Volatile Die (chaining bonus Hits), suffering a Rupture (2 Light Wounds, Pressure vents to 0) for each Hit scored in the chain.
- **Catalyst Controls:** At the start of each combat round, freely set your Catalyst Chamber Pressure to **any value of your choice (0, 1, 2, or 3)**.
- **Redline Engine:** Activate abilities even if positive cost exceeds Pressure 3 (resolves at max Pressure 3, then triggers an automatic Rupture: 2 Light Wounds, vents to 0).

## PROGRESSION

At character creation, distribute **7 Points** among Venom, Hazard, and Serum (base `1 / 1 / 1`, max 5). You begin with **1 Kit**.

**HAZARD CHASSIS PROGRESSION (LEVELS 1-5)**

| LEVEL | BENEFITS UNLOCKED | CREDIT COST |
|---|---|---|
| Level 1 | Base Chassis, 7 Attribute Points (base 1/1/1), Starting Kit, Pressure Engine (Max 3) | **100,000 Credits*** |
| Level 2 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Kit | **20,000 Credits** |
| Level 3 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Class Mod Slot (Slot 1), +1 Kit | **40,000 Credits** |
| Level 4 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Kit | **75,000 Credits** |
| Level 5 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Class Mod Slot (Slot 2) | **150,000 Credits** |

**The 100,000 Credit cost for Level 1 applies only when purchasing an additional class chassis after character creation; an operative's starting class chassis is free.*

### TACTICAL HAZARD ARCHETYPES

- **The Toxic Saboteur:** Focuses on Venom, Envenom, and Cloudkill. Scours cover with acidic gas, sets up crippling neurotoxin Downgrades, and collapses enemy formations with Decay.
- **The Combat Alchemist:** Balances Hazard with Pyro and Smoke. Dominates corridors with high-pressure Flamestrikes and thermal smoke screens, controlling lines of sight.
- **The Field Surgeon:** Maximizes Serum with Medic and Booster kits. Delivers combat-critical heals, clears mental stress, and overclocks allied initiative with emergency stimulants.

# CLASS: THE PILOT

**The Pilot is defined by direct neuro-synaptic synchronization with a specialized Pilot-pattern MANTLE (*Modular Adaptive Neural Transmission Linked Equipment*)—a motorized bio-mechanical frame that serves as both a wearable exoskeleton and an autonomous tele-operated Exodrone. Controlled directly through the operative's permanent Neural Control Chip (NCC) and cranial shunt ports along the neck and temples, the rig allows the Pilot to operate the external frame as a natural extension of their own nervous system. Visually, a Pilot presents an imposing, industrial silhouette. Lightweight ceramic-composite plating and subdermal shock-absorbing harnesses fit beneath the Exodrone's shifting mechanical carapace. In its dormant, docked configuration, the chassis folds tightly along the Pilot's spine like a segmented pair of metallic wings, its hydraulic solenoids hissing softly in rhythm with the user's pulse and cooling fans humming against the operative's back.**

In active combat, the Exodrone acts as an instrument of overwhelming mechanical force, driven by high-density solid-state battery banks and pneumatic actuators. When locked to the operative's spinal harness in Attached Mode, the Exodrone reinforces the Pilot's skeletal structure, allowing them to sprint through heavy automatic fire, shatter reinforced security bulkheads with hydraulic strikes, or stabilize heavy squad weapons without recoil fatigue. The true tactical genius of the chassis emerges when the locking pins disengage, allowing the Exodrone to detach and operate as an independent avatar. Governed by high-frequency telemetry feeds, the detached drone can advance into hazardous breaches, lay down suppressive fire from elevated vantages, provide physical barricades for pinned allies, or administer emergency trauma triage in hot landing zones while the Pilot directs operations from secure cover.

The operational versatility of the Pilot MANTLE chassis is defined by its modular firmware architecture. Rather than locking the operative into a singular battlefield duty, the Exodrone can be reconfigured with specialized hardware packages between engagements. A Pilot can optimize their frame for close-quarters breach and clear with high-frequency vibro-blades, calibrate its hardpoints into a heavy shoulder-mounted ballistic and laser artillery platform, mount pneumatic vector thrusters for frictionless three-dimensional boarding actions, or equip surgical micro-manipulators for life-saving combat stabilization. In any theater of operations, the Pilot ensures the cell possesses both a fortified anchor and a versatile remote presence capable of shifting the tactical balance at a moment's notice.

## ATTRIBUTES

The Exodrone possesses its own signature set of physical Attributes that reflect its mechanical capabilities:

- **Power:** The raw mechanical torque, hydraulic lifting capacity, and kinetic impact force generated by the Exodrone's articulated frame (corresponds to **Strength**).
- **Speed:** The rapid servo response, thruster acceleration, and swift evasive articulation of the Exodrone (corresponds to **Agility**).
- **Precision:** The micrometric fine-motor dexterity, targeting telemetry, and sensor alignment of the Exodrone (corresponds to **Finesse**).

## MECHANICS

### EXODRONE MODES

The Exodrone operates in two distinct operational states: Attached Mode and Detached Mode.

- **Attached Mode:** While docked to your spinal interface, the Exodrone reinforces your natural anatomy. Whenever you make a test involving **Strength**, **Agility**, or **Finesse**, you may choose to substitute your own Core Attribute with the Exodrone's corresponding Attribute (**Power**, **Speed**, or **Precision**).
- **Detached Mode:** When decoupled from your harness, the Exodrone acts as an autonomous tele-operated proxy. The Exodrone can navigate and take actions independently on the battlefield. When the Exodrone makes a test, it forms test pools using its own physical Attributes (for example, a test requiring Strength and Agility resolves using **Power + Speed**, while a pure Strength test resolves using **Power + Power**). If a test requires an Attribute the Exodrone does not possess (such as mental Attributes like **Knowledge**, **Presence**, or **Instinct**), the Exodrone cannot perform that action independently.

### CORE CHASSIS OPERATIONS

Every Pilot understands the foundational operation of their Exodrone chassis:

- **Detach [Free Action]:** You decouple the Exodrone from your spinal harness for **0 AP** and **0 Batteries**. The Exodrone deploys into your current space and enters Detached Mode. You may perform this action once per turn.
- **Attach [Free Action]:** You magnetically dock the Exodrone onto your spinal interface for **0 AP** and **0 Batteries** while occupying the same space as the Exodrone. The Exodrone enters Attached Mode. You may perform this action once per turn.
- **Drone Commands:** While the Exodrone is in Detached Mode, you command it over your neural link. Directing the Exodrone to move, make an attack, or perform a test costs **1 AP** from your standard 3 Action Point pool.
- **Overdrive Command [Free Action]:** You transmit an overclocked neural surge to the detached Exodrone, expending **4 Batteries**. The Exodrone immediately gains **1 Action Point** to take an action for **0 of your own AP**.

### BATTERY POWER CELLS

The Exodrone's high-torque actuators, energy carbines, and specialized modules are powered by a central bank of high-density solid-state batteries:

- **Capacity:** The Exodrone can store a maximum of **10 Batteries**.
- **Expenditure:** Activating specialized Pilot abilities expends a designated number of Batteries from this reserve.
- **Recharging:** At the beginning of each Round, the Exodrone automatically recharges **2 Batteries** if it is in Attached Mode. While in Detached Mode, it recharges 0 Batteries. During place-to-place or day-to-day pacing, the Battery pool automatically refills to maximum (10).
- **Damage & Shutdown:** When the Exodrone suffers damage while in Detached Mode, its physical casing and capacitors absorb the shock: it loses **1 Battery for every 4 points of damage suffered**, rounded down. If the Exodrone's Battery pool drops to **0 Batteries**, it enters an emergency shutdown state, collapsing and ceasing all functions until it recharges at least 1 Battery.

## PILOT ABILITIES

The Pilot customizes their Exodrone through specialized hardware and software **Modules**. Each Module is a cohesive package of three coordinated abilities designed for a distinct tactical focus. Operatives learn one complete Module (3 abilities) at Level 1, and unlock an additional Module at Levels 2, 3, and 4.

### WINGMAN MODULE

The Wingman Module emphasizes tactical synergy and coordinated maneuvers between the operative and their detached Exodrone.

**Boost [Free Action]**

- **Cost:** 1 Battery
- **Limit:** Max 3 per turn
- **Effect:** You route auxiliary current to the Exodrone's primary servos. The Exodrone gains **+1 Upgrade** to any one chosen Exodrone Attribute until the beginning of the next Player Turn.

**Double Move [Rider]**

- **Cost:** 1 Battery
- **Trigger:** When you take a Movement Action during the Player Turn.
- **Effect:** Fluid coordination allows the Exodrone to reposition alongside you. The Exodrone immediately executes a full Movement Action for **0 additional AP**.

**Tag Team [Rider]**

- **Cost:** 3 Batteries
- **Requirement:** Detached Mode, occupying the same space as the Pilot.
- **Trigger:** When you declare an action or attack.
- **Effect:** The Exodrone coordinates seamlessly with your strike. The Exodrone participates in your action using **Teamwork** for **0 additional AP**.

### WARDEN MODULE

The Warden Module configures the Exodrone into a hardened defensive bastion, absorbing ballistic trauma and providing mobile cover for the cell.

**Armadillo [Free Action]**

- **Cost:** 1 Battery
- **Limit:** Once per round
- **Requirement:** Attached Mode
- **Effect:** The Exodrone shifts its interlocking ceramic plates across your vitals. Your Physical Protection increases by **+2** until the end of the Round.

**Guardian [Reaction]**

- **Cost:** 2 Batteries
- **Trigger:** When the Exodrone is targeted by an attack.
- **Effect:** Automated counter-deflection routines engage. The Exodrone can contest the incoming attack for **0 AP**.

**Barricade [Action]**

- **Cost:** 1 Battery, 1 AP
- **Requirement:** Detached Mode
- **Effect:** The Exodrone drops into a low-profile posture and drives hydraulic anchoring spikes into the deck, converting itself into deployable mobile cover until the end of the round. The Cover Rating of the Exodrone's current space increases by **+1**. While configured as a barricade, the only action the Exodrone can take is to disengage its anchors and revert to standard mode for **0 AP**.

## DUELIST MODULE

The Duelist Module transforms the Exodrone into a lethal close-quarters combatant, mounting high-frequency cutting edges for silent breaches and melee skirmishes.

**Shadow Strike [Rider]**

- **Cost:** 1 Battery
- **Requirement:** Attached Mode, or occupying the same space as the target in Detached Mode.
- **Trigger:** After successfully landing a melee attack.
- **Effect:** The Exodrone executes an immediate hydraulic follow-up blow. Add bonus damage to your attack equal to the Exodrone Attribute corresponding to the Physical Attribute used in your attack.

**Power Weapons [Free Action]**

- **Cost:** 1 Battery
- **Effect:** The Exodrone extends twin wrist-mounted powered weapons of your choice between vibro-blades, shock-batons, or pneumatic spikes, remaining active until the end of the round. They function as dual-wielded 1H melee weapons with a **Damage Bonus of 1 plus your Pilot Level**, allowing you to choose between **Slashing** (favored pair **Agility + Strength**), **Striking** (favored pair **Strength + Finesse**) or **Piercing** (favored pair **Agility + Finesse**) damage for your melee attacks.

**Plasma Lance [Action]**

- **Cost:** 2 Batteries, 1 AP
- **Effect:** The Exodrone locks its articulated frame and unleashes a superheated thermal cutting lance in a devastating thrust against a target or structural barrier. Make a single melee attack using any melee attribute pair. On a hit, this attack deals damage with a **Damage Bonus equal to 2 plus your Pilot Level**. This damage completely ignores the target's Physical Protection (including armor, shields, and cover).

## ARSENAL MODULE

The Arsenal Module outfits the Exodrone with heavy ranged weaponry, transforming it into a versatile mobile weapons platform.

**Laser Carbine [Free Action]**

- **Cost:** 1 Battery
- **Effect:** The Exodrone deploys a wrist-mounted pulsed laser carbine, remaining active until the end of the round. It features the following firearm profile: `Acc: [3/2/1/-], Dmg: +1 + Pilot Class Level, RoF: 2`.

**Shoulder Cannon [Action]**

- **Cost:** 2 Batteries, 1 AP
- **Effect:** The Exodrone locks its chassis and discharges a concentrated high-output optical blast from its shoulder-mounted heavy laser: `Acc: [1/4/3/2], Dmg: +4 + Pilot Class Level, RoF: 0`.

**Plasma Grenade [Action]**

- **Cost:** 2 Batteries, 1 AP
- **Effect:** The Exodrone produces a small blob of superheated plasma and lobs it at any target space within Short range (0–5 spaces). The blob acts as a grenade with the following profile: `Ordnance: 3 + Pilot Class Level, 2m Radius`.

## ASSAULT MODULE

The Assault Module enhances dynamic movement, enabling the Exodrone to scale vertical obstacles, drop from high altitudes, and close combat distances rapidly.

**Full Throttle [Action]**

- **Cost:** 1 Battery, 1 AP
- **Effect:** Overcharging hydraulic leg actuators, you or your Exodrone sprint up to 12 meters in a straight line directly into a hostile creature's space and execute a melee attack as part of the same action.

**Spider Climb [Free Action]**

- **Cost:** 1 Battery
- **Effect:** Micro-fiber magnetic clamps engage across the Exodrone's extremities. Until the end of the round, the Exodrone gains **Surface Adhesion**, allowing it to move across vertical bulkheads and sheer ceilings as regular terrain.

**Jump Pack [Free Action]**

- **Cost:** 2 Batteries
- **Effect:** The Exodrone fires integrated vector thrusters, gaining the **Mobility** virtual item attribute equal to 3 + Pilot Class Level. Until the end of round, the Exodrone's and the wearer's base movement speed becomes 12, it may sacrifice Hits on movement tests to gain +4 meters of movement per Hit spent and it and its wearer ignores difficult terrain and all damage from falling until end of turn. If in mid-air, it falls at the end of the Player Turn, taking no damage.

### RECON MODULE

The Recon Module equips the Exodrone with adaptive optical cloaking, remote neural telepresence, and electronic infiltration tools.

**Active Camouflage [Free Action]**

- **Cost:** 2 Batteries
- **Effect:** The Exodrone activates adaptive light-refracting micro-panels, establishing a Persistent Blocker Effect against hostile detection from outside your space until the end of the round. Any tests that benefit from remaining unseen gain **+1 Upgrade**.

**Neural Relay [Passive]**

- **Effect:** The direct duplex telemetry feed between your NCC and the Exodrone streams full sensory perception. While the Exodrone is in Detached Mode, it can utilize your own mental Attributes (**Knowledge**, **Presence**, and **Instinct**) to perform tests, allowing it to scout hostile spaces, slice electronic terminals, or perform technical analysis remotely.

**Omni Tool [Action]**

- **Cost:** 1 Battery, 1 AP
- **Requirement:** Detached Mode
- **Effect:** The Exodrone interfaces directly with an electronic terminal, locked hatch, or sensor console in its space, forcing the device to perform any standard function without requiring an external tool. When executing the hack, roll the Exodrone's highest physical Attribute in place of Finesse.

### SERAPH MODULE

The Seraph Module equips the Exodrone with emergency trauma medicine and vital-sign resuscitation hardware, allowing it to stabilize wounded operatives under fire.

**First Aid [Action]**

- **Cost:** 2 Batteries (increasing by +1 Battery for each additional use within the same Round)
- **Effect:** In Attached Mode, the Exodrone administers rapid trauma coagulants and painkillers to you, immediately healing **2 Light Wounds**. In Detached Mode, the Exodrone injects a target friendly creature occupying its current space, healing **2 Light Wounds**.

**Healer Darts [Free Action]**

- **Cost:** 2 Batteries
- **Effect:** The Exodrone deploys a pneumatic dart projector, active until the end of the round. It features the following profile: `Acc: [2/-/-/-], Dmg: 0, RoF: 0`. On a successful hit against an ally, rather than dealing damage, the dart injects stimulant biomaterials that heal **1 Light Wound for every 2 Success Points** scored on the attack roll.

**Trauma Protocol [Action]**

- **Cost:** 4 Batteries, 1 AP
- **Requirement:** Detached Mode
- **Effect:** The Exodrone moves into the space of an incapacitated or dying ally, locking its armored chassis around the patient. Make an emergency medicine test using the Exodrone's Precision + your Instinct: each 2 SP heals 1 Light Wound, or each 4 SP clears 1 Aggravated Wound. If the target was killed during the current Round, scoring at least 2 SP revives the target with 1 Light Wound. While clamped onto an ally, all incoming damage targeting that ally is redirected to the Exodrone until it detaches.

## CLASS MODS & PROGRESSION

Pilot Class Mods cost **25,000 Credits** each and can be installed into open chassis mod slots (unlocked at Levels 3 and 5; maximum 2 active mods):

- **Solid-State Expansion Bank:** Auxiliary battery capacitors expand the Exodrone's total storage capacity from 10 to **12 Batteries**.
- **Tethered Inductive Field:** Hardened induction coils reinforce the Exodrone's damage dissipation. While in Detached Mode, the Exodrone loses 1 Battery per **6 points of damage suffered** (instead of 4). In addition, the Exodrone recharges 1 Battery at the start of each round even while in Detached Mode.
- **Biomechanical Dynamo:** Micro-generators capture the kinetic energy of your physical movements. While in Attached Mode, whenever you score Hits on a physical test, you may convert 1 Hit into **1 Battery** recharged (up to your maximum capacity).
- **Kinetic Overclock:** Activating any Pilot ability routes surplus current to all secondary actuators, granting **+1 Upgrade** to the Exodrone's next test before the end of your turn. This effect stacks up to twice per turn.
- **Standby Capacitor Loop:** If no Battery abilities were activated during a Round, the Exodrone's idle induction cycle automatically stores **2 additional Batteries** at the end of the Round.

**PILOT CHASSIS PROGRESSION (LEVELS 1-5)**

| LEVEL | BENEFITS UNLOCKED | CREDIT COST |
|---|---|---|
| Level 1 | Base Chassis, 7 Attribute Points (base 1/1/1), Starting Module, Battery Engine | **100,000 Credits*** |
| Level 2 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Module (3 Abilities) | **20,000 Credits** |
| Level 3 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Class Mod Slot (Slot 1), +1 Module (3 Abilities) | **40,000 Credits** |
| Level 4 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Module (3 Abilities) | **75,000 Credits** |
| Level 5 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Class Mod Slot (Slot 2) | **150,000 Credits** |

**The 100,000 Credit cost for Level 1 applies only when purchasing an additional class chassis after character creation; an operative's starting class chassis is free.*

# CLASS: THE VANGUARD

**The Vanguard is the cell's frontline breaker and kinetic specialist, defined by their neural synchronization with a specialized Vanguard-pattern MANTLE (*Modular Adaptive Neural Transmission Linked Equipment*) and its adaptable multi-segment Board. Controlled directly through the operative's permanent Neural Control Chip (NCC) and cervical shunt, the rig interfaces with subdermal balance nodes embedded along the user's calves, spine, and forearms. Mounted along the operative's spine via a high-torque magnetic docking latch, this articulated piece of aerospace-grade hardware consists of interlocking ceramic-composite plates, micro-servos, and pneumatic locking pins that read minute shifts in center of mass, transmitting physical balance feedback at the speed of reflex. In its dormant state, the folded chassis rests as a compact, streamlined dorsal carapace across the operative's back, often scarred by shrapnel deflection or thermal wash from high-speed descents.**

In active combat, the Board functions as an instrument of relentless momentum, transforming between three distinct operational geometries at a moment's notice. When facing suppressive fire, the chassis snaps forward into the Vanguard's off-hand, locking into a broad, reinforced **Shield** engineered to disperse heavy ballistic impacts and batter through enemy barricades in close-quarters breaches. When rapid repositioning or flanking becomes necessary, the mechanism deploys beneath the user's boots as a hoverboard **Glider**, engaging vectored thrusters to skim over hazardous terrain, traverse zero-gravity gaps, and launch the operative into aerial drop attacks. When distant threats demand decisive force, the Board hinges outward into a heavy shoulder-slung or hip-braced **Cannon**, cycling heavy penetrator rounds capable of punching clean through bulkhead plating and mechanized armor.

The true tactical depth of the Vanguard MANTLE chassis lies in the fluid, stance-dancing rhythm of its kinetic engine. Rather than committing to a single combat posture, an experienced Vanguard continuously reconfigures the Board mid-assault, converting the mechanical torque of each form swap into banked **Boost** dice that fuel explosive combo techniques. Whether shattering enemy defensive lines with a boosted shield charge, surfing over crossfire to extract a pinned ally, or laying down devastating artillery blasts from elevated vantage points, the Vanguard commands the pace of engagement. Their presence ensures the cell possesses an immovable defensive anchor, an agile vanguard scout, and a heavy fire-support platform unified in a single operative.

## ATTRIBUTES

The Vanguard's three primary Attributes correspond to the different forms their Board can take:

- **Shield:** The toughness, structural mass, and kinetic impact absorption of its shield form.
- **Glider:** The speed, vector acceleration, and frictionless maneuverability of its hoverboard form.
- **Cannon:** The penetrative power, optical range, and ballistic precision of its ranged weapon form.

## MECHANICS

### VANGUARD FORMS

The Vanguard's Board has three different forms, corresponding to the three Attributes in its kit. Each form provides distinct tactical benefits:

- **Shield:** While in Shield Form, your Physical Protection increases by half your Shield Attribute, rounded down. You can also use the Shield as a Striking melee weapon (rolling **Strength + Shield**), dealing bonus damage equal to the lower Attribute in the pair (Strength or Shield). You can also use your Shield Attribute to contest most forms of incoming harm. You have one hand occupied while in Shield Form. You typically rely on **Strength** in Shield Form.
- **Glider:** While in Glider Form, you can use your Glider Attribute in any movement action you take. You also ignore Difficult Terrain and fall damage. While in the air, you can move horizontally or downward, but not upward, and only using your Glider Attribute. You have both hands free while in Glider Form. You typically rely on **Agility** in Glider Form.
- **Cannon:** While in Cannon Form, you can make a ranged attack using your Board. Its Accuracy is equal to your Cannon Attribute at short range and one less at every subsequent range band. If you would get negative Accuracy, you cannot shoot at that range. You have both hands occupied in Cannon Form. You typically rely on **Finesse** in Cannon Form.

### SWITCHING & SWAPPING FORMS

The Board is an adaptable kinetic weapon chassis capable of rapid mechanical reconfiguration. Its operational state is governed by two core concepts:

- **Current Form & Shifting Forms:** Whenever you roll a test that uses one of your Vanguard Attributes (such as a melee attack with **Shield**, a Movement Action with **Glider**, or a ranged attack with **Cannon**) or activate a Vanguard ability, your Board automatically shifts into that Form immediately prior to resolving the action. You remain in that form until your Board transforms again. Taking a test with a Vanguard Attribute or executing an ability inherently counts as a **Form Move** for that Form during the current turn.
- **Specific Form & Setup Requirements:** While most abilities automatically shift your Board into their associated Form upon activation, certain abilities have specific prerequisites:
  - **Required Starting Form:** Reactions and defensive stances (such as *Repulse* and *Brick Wall*) require you to *already* be in that specific Form when triggered.
  - **Form Moves:** Kinetic combo follow-ups (such as *Turbo Slam*) require a preceding Form Move to build the necessary momentum.
  - **Situational Requirements:** Aerial maneuvers (such as *Meteor Crash*) require specific environmental positioning (e.g. being at least 4 meters above your target space).

### BOOSTS & FORM MOMENTUM

To channel kinetic momentum into explosive combos, the Vanguard banks kinetic energy as **Boost** dice. A **Boost** is a single banked **d10** die. You can hold only **one** Boost die at a time in your reserve (unless increased by Class Mods like *Twin Turbo*). Banked Boost dice power signature Vanguard combo finishers and riders, or bolster regular actions.

**Gaining a Boost:** There are two ways to generate and bank a Boost die:

1. **Active Form Swap (1 AP):** Spend **1 AP** to swap into any of your three forms (Shield, Glider, or Cannon). Swapping immediately places you in that form, counts as a **Form Move**, and grants a banked **d10 Boost die** (replacing any previously held Boost).
2. **Banking a Hit:** When rolling a test using a Vanguard Attribute while holding no Boost die, you may bank one **Hit (8+)** from the roll into your reserve as a **d10 Boost die** (that die does not contribute to successes or effects).

**Spending a Boost:** Spend your Boost die by rolling it and adding it to any Vanguard test pool (before or after the roll). Many abilities also consume your active Boost die to unleash devastating kinetic strikes, high-altitude maneuvers, or heavy artillery blasts.

**The Golden Rule of Boosts: You can either spend or gain a Boost during a test or action, but never both.** You cannot gain a Boost on an action where you spent a Boost, and a newly gained Boost is banked to fuel future actions.

## VANGUARD ABILITIES

The Vanguard reconfigures their Board into coordinated combat routines called **Combos**. Each Combo contains three synergized abilities: an opening setup, a devastating finisher, and a responsive tactical rider or passive.

Operatives learn one complete Combo (3 abilities) at Level 1, and unlock an additional Combo at Levels 2, 3, and 4. Activating an ability automatically shifts your Board into that ability's **Form**, unless noted.

### SENTINEL COMBO

The Sentinel Combo emphasizes frontline defense, utilizing shield throws to scatter enemy formations and reactive bracing to protect against incoming fire.

**Shield Throw [Action]**

- **Form:** Shield
- **Effect:** You hurl your Board in Shield Form up to 20 meters as a ranged melee attack (rolling **Strength + Shield**). The Shield ricochets off the target and snaps immediately back to your magnetic gauntlet. It deals your standard Shield melee damage at range.

**Ricochet [Rider]**

- **Form:** Shield
- **Trigger:** When your **Shield Throw** successfully hits a target.
- **Effect:** You may expend your active **Boost** die. If you do, kinetic resonance arcs through the target's space: every other hostile creature in that space suffers damage equal to the damage dealt to the primary target.

**Repulse [Reaction]**

- **Form:** Shield
- **Requirement:** Shield Form (must already be in Shield Form)
- **Trigger:** When you are targeted by an attack while in Shield Form.
- **Effect:** You can contest the incoming attack using your Shield Attribute for **0 AP** by expending your active **Boost** die. Add the **Boost** die directly to your contest roll.

## FALLINGSTAR COMBO

The Fallingstar Combo harnesses explosive vertical lift and high-altitude drops, crushing enemy clusters beneath devastating shockwaves.

**Rocket Jump [Action]**

- **Form:** Cannon
- **Effect:** You angle your Cannon directly into the ground beneath you and fire a high-pressure kinetic blast, rolling a **Cannon Success Test** (you may expend and add your active **Boost** die to this test). The blast deals damage to all creatures in your space equal to your Cannon Attribute; if you expended a **Boost** die on the test, it instead deals damage to all creatures in your space equal to the highest die rolled. The explosion immediately lifts you 4 meters straight up into the air, and you can spend any **Hits** from the test to activate **Push Effects** on yourself. This action also counts as a **Glider Move**.

**Meteor Crash [Action]**

- **Form:** Shield
- **Requirement:** Elevated position (must fall or dive from at least 4 meters above your target space).
- **Effect:** You slam directly into the space beneath you, ignoring all fall damage. You deal damage equal to your Shield Attribute to all creatures in the target space. If you expend an active **Boost** die, roll the Boost die and add the rolled result to the total damage dealt.

**Air Trick [Rider]**

- **Form:** Glider
- **Trigger:** When taking a Movement Action using your Glider (Glider Move) starting from solid ground.
- **Effect:** You can convert horizontal thrust into vertical flight for up to 4 meters of your movement, easily leaping 4 meters into the air to set up a devastating **Meteor Crash**. You fall at the end of the Player Turn unless sustained by another ability.

## FALCON COMBO

The Falcon Combo is engineered for rapid skirmishing, frictionless traversal, and high-altitude momentum, allowing the Vanguard to reposition across the battlefield and strike without becoming pinned.

**Rocketeer [Action]**

- **Form:** Glider
- **Effect:** You make a Glider Movement Action and fly for the entire duration of the movement. If you expend an active **Boost** die, add the Boost die to your movement test roll; you double the rolled movement distance and fly at extreme velocity without altitude loss until the end of the Player Turn.

**Hit and Run [Rider]**

- **Form:** Glider
- **Requirement:** Glider Move (must have completed a Glider Move this turn).
- **Trigger:** As part of declaring any melee attack.
- **Effect:** You can move a number of meters equal to your **Glider Attribute × 4 meters** either immediately before or immediately after making the attack. This movement is completely fluid and cannot be contested by enemies.

**Windsurfer [Passive]**

- **Form:** Glider
- **Effect:** While in Glider Form, you do not fall at the end of the Player Turn. Instead, you remain suspended at your current altitude. You can maneuver horizontally across the airspace as long as you use your Glider to move. If you swap out of Glider Form, you fall at the end of that Player Turn.

## SCORPION COMBO

The Scorpion Combo converts the Vanguard's Board into a heavy ballistic platform, laying down sustained automatic suppressive fire and punishing openings with devastating follow-up cannonades.

**Assault Cannon [Passive]**

- **Form:** Cannon
- **Effect:** Your Board reconfigures into an Assault Cannon. While in Cannon Form, your weapon gains a **Damage Bonus of +2** and a **Rate of Fire of 2**, but suffers **-1 Accuracy** across all range bands. This configuration cannot be combined with *Long Cannon* (if you possess both abilities, you choose which configuration your Cannon Form takes during downtime).

**Charged Shot [Action]**

- **Form:** Cannon
- **Effect:** Make a ranged attack using your Cannon, expending your active **Boost** die. Add the **Boost** die to your attack roll. On a hit, you puncture the target's armor, dealing bonus damage equal to your Cannon Attribute.

**Follow Up [Rider]**

- **Form:** Any Form
- **Trigger:** After successfully landing any attack in any form (Shield, Glider, or Cannon).
- **Effect:** You can immediately pay **1 AP** to deliver a point-blank snap shot with your Cannon against the target, dealing bonus damage equal to your Cannon Attribute. If you expend an active **Boost** die, roll the Boost die and add damage equal to the result you rolled. This attack immediately swaps your Board into Cannon Form. You can execute this follow-up even if the Player Turn would otherwise end.

## RHINO COMBO

The Rhino Combo focuses on battlefield displacement and immovable close-quarters enforcement, harpooning priority targets, smashing them into structural barriers, and locking down all movement.

**Hook Shot [Action]**

- **Form:** Cannon
- **Effect:** You fire a high-tensile magnetic kinetic tether from your Cannon at an anchor point or creature up to Short range (16 meters):
  - **Inanimate Anchor:** You are immediately winched in a straight line directly to the anchor point.
  - **Hostile Creature:** Roll a **Cannon + Finesse Simple Test**. If no Hits are scored, the shot misses and the tether snaps back. If you score at least one Hit, the tether latches on; you can spend any **Hits** from the roll to activate **Push Effects** that pull the target creature 1 space (4 meters) directly towards you per Hit spent (even if you only roll a single Hit, spending it on this Push Effect still counts the Hook Shot as a success). Following the pull, you may advance along the tether line any number of spaces towards the target (up to entering its space). If you and the target make contact (ending in the same space), you deal collision damage to the target equal to the highest die rolled. This action also counts as a **Glider Move**.

**Turbo Slam [Action]**

- **Form:** Shield
- **Requirement:** Glider Move (must have completed a Glider Move this turn, such as advancing via *Hook Shot* or Glider movement, to convert kinetic momentum into impact force).
- **Effect:** Make a melee strike with your Shield, dealing bonus damage equal to your Shield Attribute. If the target is large or smaller, you may push it a number of meters equal to the damage dealt. If the pushed creature collides with solid cover, a bulkhead, or another combatant, it suffers bonus damage equal to your Shield Attribute again.

**Brick Wall [Reaction]**

- **Form:** Shield
- **Requirement:** Shield Form (must already be in Shield Form)
- **Trigger:** When a creature attempts to move across or out of your space while you are in Shield Form.
- **Effect:** Contest the creature's movement using your Shield Attribute. If you succeed, their movement is halted, and they take damage equal to the highest die you eliminated from their roll. You can also trigger this reaction to contest forced movement triggered by your allies during the Player Turn, even if the Player Turn would normally end.

## ROOK COMBO

The Rook Combo transforms the Vanguard into an immovable battlefield bastion, deploying reinforced fortifications to shelter squad members, ferrying allies rapidly across hostile firing lanes, and returning heavy ranged fire from behind hardened ballistic plating.

**Gun Shield [Passive]**

- **Form:** Shield
- **Effect:** Your Board's Shield Form incorporates an articulated weapon brace and magnetic clamp. You can wield and fire a two-handed firearm while in Shield Form, retaining your Shield Form's Physical Protection bonus (+SHD/2).

**Hitchhiker [Rider]**

- **Form:** Glider
- **Requirement:** Glider Move
- **Trigger:** When declaring a Movement Action using your Glider.
- **Effect:** One willing ally in your space or an adjacent space can latch onto your harness or board. They are carried with you for the full duration of your movement for **0 AP**, ending their movement in your destination space. If you end your movement by swapping into Shield Form or deploying your **Tactical Barricade**, the hitched ally immediately shares the fortified space and its cover. You can expend an active **Boost** die to add the Boost die to your movement test roll and carry up to two allies simultaneously.

**Tactical Barricade [Action]**

- **Form:** Shield
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** You spend 1 AP to drive your Board into the ground, deploying an immovable kinetic barricade that provides **Medium Cover (+2 Protection)** to you and any allies within your space against attacks originating from outside the space. If you expend an active **Boost** die when deploying the barricade, it reinforces into **Heavy Cover (+3 Protection)**. Occupants sheltering behind the barricade are anchored and immune to forced movement (such as push or pull effects). Enemies cannot enter or cross the barricade's space without succeeding on an opposed contest against your **Shield**. You can reclaim the Board back into standard Shield Form for **0 AP** whenever you declare a Movement Action or swap forms.

### HAWK COMBO

The Hawk Combo configures the Board into an extreme-range precision marksman rifle, utilizing gyroscopic stabilization and telemetry tracking across vast engagement distances.

**Long Cannon [Passive]**

- **Form:** Cannon
- **Effect:** Your Board reconfigures into a Long Cannon sniper platform. While in Cannon Form, your Board suffers **-1 Accuracy** at Short range, gains **+1 Accuracy** at Long and Extreme range, and gains a **Damage Bonus of +2** when firing at Medium range or farther. This configuration cannot be combined with *Assault Cannon* (if you possess both abilities, you choose which configuration your Cannon Form takes during downtime).

**Tracking Shot [Action]**

- **Form:** Cannon
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Effect:** Make a ranged attack using your Long Cannon against a visible target. For each Hit you choose to set aside from the attack roll, you paint the target with a persistent telemetry tag, granting an automatic Hit on your next ranged attack made against that target during the current Round.

**Overwatch [Reaction]**

- **Form:** Cannon
- **Cost:** 1 AP
- **Trigger:** When a target affected by your Tracking Shot tag declares an action or attempts a Movement Action.
- **Effect:** You consume 1 automatic Hit granted by Tracking Shot to fire an intercepting snap shot at the target before its declared action resolves. Roll a **Cannon Success Test** to determine the damage dealt by the shot.

## CLASS MODS

Vanguard Class Mods cost **25,000 Credits** each and can be socketed into open chassis mod slots (unlocked at Levels 3 and 5; maximum 2 active mods):

- **Twin Turbo:** Advanced dual-capacitor banks allow you to hold up to two **Boost** dice at the same time. When spending Boost, you may choose to expend one or both banked dice on the same action.
- **Cheat Move:** Once per round, you can change your Board's form without spending AP (**0 AP**), and this transition still counts as a legitimate **Form Move** for combo prerequisites.
- **Head Start:** At the start of each Round during combat pacing, you can swap to any desired Form for free (**0 AP**). If you do not currently hold a Boost die, you immediately gain one **d10 Boost die**.
- **Hesitation Moves:** Inertial stabilizers preserve kinetic charge. You qualify for Form Move requirements if you performed the corresponding Form Move at any point during the current **Round**, rather than strictly during your current turn.
- **Boost Buildup:** At the end of the Player Turn, if you have remained in the same Form and have not swapped Forms during that turn, kinetic pressure builds up and grants you one **d10 Boost die**.

## PROGRESSION

At character creation, distribute **7 Class Creation Points** among Shield, Glider, and Cannon (base 1 / 1 / 1; maximum starting rating of 5). You begin with **1 complete Combo** of your choice.

**VANGUARD CHASSIS PROGRESSION (LEVELS 1-5)**

| LEVEL | BENEFITS UNLOCKED | CREDIT COST |
|---|---|---|
| Level 1 | Base Chassis, 7 Attribute Points (base 1/1/1), Starting Combo, Boost Engine | **100,000 Credits*** |
| Level 2 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Combo (3 Abilities) | **20,000 Credits** |
| Level 3 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Class Mod Slot (Slot 1), +1 Combo (3 Abilities) | **40,000 Credits** |
| Level 4 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Combo (3 Abilities) | **75,000 Credits** |
| Level 5 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Class Mod Slot (Slot 2) | **150,000 Credits** |

**The 100,000 Credit cost for Level 1 applies only when purchasing an additional class chassis after character creation; an operative's starting class chassis is free.*

# CLASS: THE WEAVER

**The Weaver is the cell's master of molecular manipulation and on-the-fly fabrication, defined by total neural command over a specialized Weaver-pattern MANTLE (*Modular Adaptive Neural Transmission Linked Equipment*) housing millions of microscopic Nanites. Controlled directly through the operative's permanent Neural Control Chip (NCC) and cranial shunt, the rig centers around pressurized titanium-ceramic reservoirs anchored to the thoracic spine and routed across the body through subdermal micro-manifolds. Visually, a Weaver cuts an unmistakable, iridescent silhouette. Dormant nanite fluid constantly cycles across their person, pooling into shifting metallic scarves, flowing cloaks, or reinforced layers of kinetic weave that shimmer with subtle chromatic pulses. With a single neuro-synaptic impulse, these fluid fabrics can instantly solidify into razor-sharp monomolecular blades, lock into rigid ballistic plating, or atomize into an airborne cloud of micro-mechanical dust.**

In active combat, the Weaver's reservoir operates under hard-science principles of programmable matter and high-frequency magnetic confinement fields. Billions of microscopic, multi-jointed alloy nodes rapidly interlock at the molecular level, allowing the Weaver to fabricate tools, forge weapons, or reinforce structural bulkheads in mere seconds. The experience of commanding the swarm is intensely tactile; operatives describe a distinct hum along their nerve endings as high-density telemetry streams back through their shunt port, conveying the structural integrity, surface tension, and molecular density of their creations in real time. Rather than carrying cumbersome bags of situational gear, the Weaver carries raw structural potential, reshaping their metallic fluid to solve logistical hurdles or tactical crises as they unfold.

The modular versatility of the Weaver MANTLE chassis makes it the ultimate force multiplier across all operational theaters. An operative can tune their nanite suspension into solid-state ballistic shields and physical armor to anchor a defensive perimeter, forge high-leverage melee blades or precision-calibrated long guns, weave aerodynamic aerofoils for effortless 3D flight, or flood allied tissue with cellular micro-sutures and clotting agents for emergency field triage. In technical environments, the nanite swarm can infiltrate sealed data ports and electronic consoles, short-circuiting security networks from the inside out. Whatever the mission demands, the Weaver ensures the cell is never without the right tool for the job.

## ATTRIBUTES

A Weaver's capabilities are governed by three Class Attributes:

- **Create:** Molecular structural synthesis, solidifying dormant nanite fluid into functional physical tools, shields, and armaments.
- **Control:** Telemetric dynamic manipulation, guiding active swarms and directing forged constructs across spatial vectors.
- **Modify:** Precision lattice bonding, infusing existing equipment, physical structures, and organic tissue with adaptive nanite layers.

## BASIC MECHANICS

When utilizing nanite capabilities, you roll tests using your Weaver Attributes. By default, your raw nanites can only create, modify, or manipulate simple objects that do not possess combat statistics or specialized properties—such as basic prybars, ropes, lockpicks, simple furniture, or utilitarian covers. Forging functional weapons, ballistic armor, medical consumables, or electronic viruses requires unlocking the corresponding **Nanite Weaves**.

To execute a nanite test, you declare your narrative action and pair your chosen Weaver Attribute with an appropriate Core Attribute (`Class + Core`), or with another Weaver Attribute (`Class + Class`). For example, combine **Create + Strength** to forge a heavy prybar and wrench open a jammed hatch, pair **Create + Finesse** to fabricate a micro-lockpick and align security tumblers, roll **Control + Instinct** to thread a nanite sensory cable beneath a blast door, or use **Modify + Presence** to subtly alter the identification text and seal on an executive credential.

### THE NANITE RESERVOIR

Every Weaver maintains a physical reserve of programmable matter, measured in **Reserve**:

- **Baseline Capacity:** Operatives start with a capacity of **4 Reserve**.
- **Physical Volume:** A single point of Reserve corresponds to roughly 1 liter of concentrated nanite fluid held within the operative's pressurized dorsal canisters and subcutaneous manifold lines.
- **Material Scale & Density:** Stretched to its structural limits, 1 Reserve can produce a 24-meter cable, a 1-square-meter rigid surface, or handheld items equivalent to Load 1–2:
  - **1 Reserve:** Handheld tools, cables, grappling hooks, 1H weapons, simple containers (Load 1–2).
  - **2 Reserve:** Ladders, chairs, full hazard suits, 2H firearms, deployable barriers (Load 3–4).
  - **3 Reserve:** Reinforced benches, heavy 1m × 1m blast walls, pressurized airlocks (Load 5–6).
- **Workspace Limitation:** You deploy nanites in the **space you currently occupy**, unless an ability extends range.
- **Load Invariant:** All items forged purely from nanites have an effective **Load of 0**. Modifications applied to existing equipment preserve that equipment's original Load.
- **Instant Disassembly [Free Action]:** Decouple, liquefy, and siphon creations back into your reservoir at any time for **0 AP**, instantly recovering spent **Reserve**.
- **Reserve Cycles:** When spent Reserve recharges at the start of next round or end of turn, it is actively circulating and cannot be allocated until the duration elapses.

## CLASS ABILITIES

Weaver abilities are grouped into thematic packages called **Nanite Weaves**. Each Weave is a tripartite suite containing three specialized applications—one for **Create**, one for **Modify**, and one for **Control**. Operatives select one starting Weave at character creation, and unlock an additional Weave at Levels 2, 3, and 4.

### HARDWEAVE

HardWeave configures your nanite swarm into high-density interlocking crystalline lattices engineered to absorb catastrophic kinetic shock and deflect incoming fire.

**HardWeave Shield [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Create
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Micro-crystallized plates interlock across your forearm to form a rigid ballistic barrier.* You forge a physical shield in your space for yourself or an ally. It functions as a **1H shield** (Min STR 0, Load 0) granting a base **+1 Physical Protection Bonus**. Roll an Action Roll using **Create**. Each **Hit** spent increases the shield's Protection Bonus by **+1**.

**HardWeave Armor [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Modify
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Adaptive fluid seeps into seams and weave layers, hardening upon impact to distribute concussive force.* You reinforce worn armor on yourself or an ally in your space. Roll an Action Roll using **Modify**. Each **Hit** spent increases the armor's **Physical Protection by +1** until the end of the round.

**HardWeave Block [Reaction]**

- **Attribute:** Control
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve (recharges at the start of the next round)
- **Trigger:** When you or an ally in your space are targeted by an attack.
- **Effect:** *A reactive burst of pressurized nanites flashes outward to deflect an incoming projectile or blade.* You can contest the incoming attack for **0 AP**, rolling your **Contest Roll** using your **Control** Attribute instead of your standard physical Attributes.

### SLICEWEAVE

SliceWeave aligns your nanite swarm into high-density cutting geometries, honing edges to monomolecular sharpness capable of parting composite armor and bone with equal ease.

**SliceWeave Blade [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Create
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Metallic fluid coalesces into an ergonomic hilt and extends a razor-honed blade of solid carbide alloy.* You forge a melee weapon in your space for yourself or an ally. It functions as a **1H melee weapon** (Min STR 0, Load 0, base **Damage Bonus +1**). When forged, declare its damage property: **Piercing** (favored pair **Agility + Finesse**), **Slashing** (favored pair **Agility + Strength**), or **Striking** (favored pair **Strength + Finesse**). Roll an Action Roll using **Create**. Each **Hit** spent increases the weapon's flat **Damage Bonus by +1**.

**SliceWeave Edge [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Modify
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A vibrating monomolecular ribbon bonds along the striking edge of an existing weapon.* You reinforce a melee weapon in your space. Roll an Action Roll using **Modify**. Each **Hit** spent increases the weapon's flat **Damage Bonus by +1** until the end of the round.

**SliceWeave Slash [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Control
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve (recharges at the start of the next round), 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A scything ribbon of high-velocity nanites lashes across the air in a lethal, sweeping arc.* Select your current space or one adjacent space and roll a **Control Success Test**. You inflict **Slashing** damage equal to your **Success Points + your Control Attribute** to all designated targets in the chosen space. You may spend additional available Reserve (which recharges at the start of the next round) to include one additional space per Reserve spent.

## BOLTWEAVE

BoltWeave structures nanites into high-tolerance magnetic accelerator barrels, tailored propellant chambers, and aerodynamically perfected kinetic sabots.

**BoltWeave Weapon [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Create
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Fluid alloy solidifies into a shoulder-fired long gun with calibrated magnetic rails and an optical rail.* You forge a firearm in your space for yourself or an ally. It functions as a **2H firearm** (Min STR 0, Load 0) with a base weapon profile: `Acc: [3 / 2 / 1 / 0], RoF: 1, Dmg: +1`. Roll an Action Roll using **Create**. Each **Hit** spent allows you to calibrate the firearm by selecting one of the following options (you cannot choose the same option twice; different Accuracy band pairs count as separate options):
  - Increase flat **Damage Bonus by +2**.
  - Increase **Rate of Fire (RoF) by +2**.
  - Increase two adjacent **Accuracy bands by +1** each (cannot increase a single band by +2).

**BoltWeave Ammo [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Modify
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve (recharges at the start of the next round), 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Chambered ammunition is coated in high-mass sabot jackets and terminal guidance fins.* You infuse and calibrate the ammunition of an ally occupying your space. Roll an Action Roll using **Modify**. Each **Hit** spent grants that ally's firearm attacks your choice of the following benefits until the end of the round:
  - **+1 Damage Bonus**.
  - **+1 Rate of Fire (RoF)**.
  - **+1 Accuracy in a single range band** (this cannot grant the ability to fire at a range band the weapon cannot naturally engage, marked `-`).

  The spent Reserve recharges at the start of the next round.

**BoltWeave Bullet [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Control
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve (recharges at the start of the next round), 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Pressurized reservoir coils launch a dense, hyper-velocity slug directly from your harness.* Make a ranged attack against a creature or object within **Short range (0–5 spaces)**, rolling a **Control Success Test**. You inflict kinetic damage equal to your **Success Points + your Control Attribute**.

## FLOATWEAVE

FloatWeave integrates aerostatic micro-turbines, magnetic repulsion baffles, and aerodynamic surface foils into your constructs to conquer vertical terrain and master 3D movement.

**FloatWeave Infusion [Passive]**

- **Attribute:** Create
- **Effect:** *Internal counter-grav nodes and micro-thrusters allow forged items to hover weightlessly.* Any item or weapon you create with your nanites gains integrated levitation. These creations hover freely within your space, move alongside you without requiring hands to carry, and can be wielded or operated **hands-free** using your **Control or Create** Attribute in place of the normal required Core Attribute (such as firing a hovering BoltWeave rifle or striking with a floating SliceWeave blade).

**FloatWeave Wings [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Modify
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Articulated aerofoil wings of layered composite feather-plates unfold from the recipient's shoulders.* You attach wings to yourself or an ally in your space. The recipient gains **Flight** (base speed 4 meters, ascending costs double, ignores Difficult Terrain, and hovers in place). The recipient is immune to falling damage while the wings remain attached. When the recipient takes a movement action, they may execute their movement by rolling a Success Test using your **Modify** or **Control** Attribute.

**FloatWeave Wind [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Control
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve (recharges at the end of the turn), 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A howling micro-vortex of directed air and swirling nanites lifts you bodily into the air.* Until the end of your turn, you gain **Flight** and can use your **Control** Attribute on all Movement Actions.

## LIFEWEAVE

LifeWeave programs microscopic bio-medical assembler nodes capable of cellular reconstruction, accelerated tissue granulation, and synthetic neural bridging.

**LifeWeave Elixir [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Create
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Nanites suspend themselves in a concentrated metabolic nutrient fluid inside a sealed autoinjector.* You synthesize a consumable injector (Load 0). When a creature consumes the elixir as an Action, the user rolls a **Create Success Test** using your Create rating. For every **2 Success Points**, the user heals **1 Light Wound or 1 Light Stress**.

**LifeWeave Heal [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Modify
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve (recharges at the start of the next round), 1 AP
- **Effect:** *Active medical micro-swarms flood an open wound to cauterize vessels and knit torn flesh.* You inject medical nanites directly into an injured creature occupying your space. Roll a **Modify Success Test**. For every **3 Success Points**, you heal **2 Light Wounds** on the target.

**LifeWeave Enhancement [Passive]**

- **Attribute:** Control
- **Effect:** *Subdermal nanite filaments weave through muscle fibers and neural pathways to augment physical and mental performance.* Any creature affected by your other LifeWeave abilities can substitute your **Control** Attribute in place of any Core Attribute on their tests until the end of the round.

## MIRAGEWEAVE

MirageWeave commands nanites to align their surfaces into microscopic refractive lenses, sound-absorbing baffles, and adaptive pigments that bend light, alter physical appearances, and deaden acoustic signatures.

**MirageWeave Infusion [Passive]**

- **Attribute:** Create
- **Effect:** *Adaptive photonic metamaterials and micro-pigments reshape the surface of your fabrications.* You can alter the visual texture, markings, and finish of any item you create to make it appear authentic, legitimate, or disguised. You may use your **Create** Attribute on any tests made while utilizing the fabricated item. Furthermore, whenever you roll to Create an object, you may sacrifice **Hits** from your Action Roll to establish a **Sustained Blocker Effect** (1 Blocker die per 2 Hits sacrificed) that opposes any attempts by hostile creatures to visually spot, detect, or identify the item.

**MirageWeave Coating [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Modify
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** *A shimmering, light-refracting film crawls across skin, armor, and gear to reshape silhouettes or mimic identities.* You coat a creature or object in your space. You can cosmetically alter the target's physical appearance, colors, uniforms, insignia, or facial features to disguise them. You can also roll **Modify** on tests relying on the coated creature or object to remain unseen or relying on other creatures to believe your disguise is authentic. Additionally, you may roll an Action Roll using **Modify**; for every **2 Hits** sacrificed, you establish a **Sustained Blocker Effect** (1 Blocker die per 2 Hits sacrificed) opposing all attempts to perceive, detect, or target the coated subject from outside its space.

**MirageWeave Veil [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Control
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve (recharges at the start of the next round), 1 AP
- **Effect:** *An obscuring aerosol cloud of blackout nanites and optical chaff billows outward to shield your cell.* You disperse a mobile veil of refractive nanites that moves with you and covers your current space, shielding everyone within it. Roll an Action Roll using **Control**. For every **2 Hits** sacrificed, you establish a **Blocker Effect** (1 Blocker die per 2 Hits sacrificed) against incoming ranged attacks and visual detection from outside the space. This veil lasts until the beginning of the next Player Turn, but instantly breaks and dissipates if any creature makes an attack from within the veil.

### CYBERWEAVE

CyberWeave configures nanites into conductive micro-circuitry, logic gates, and sensor diodes capable of infiltrating and dominating electronic systems.

**CyberWeave Drone [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Create
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** You assemble a palm-sized hexapod crawler drone in your space. Roll a **Create Success Test**. For every **2 Success Points**, allocate a +1 bonus between its **Interfacing** or **Sensors** ratings. The drone moves up to 20 meters per round and can slice terminals or transmit telemetry. It disassembles if damaged or moving beyond 40 meters.

**CyberWeave Virus [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Modify
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** You infect an electronic terminal, locked blast door, or sensor node in your space. Rolling **Modify**, you force the device to execute a standard function, display a false error, or short-circuit its primary bus. You can re-trigger this effect remotely within 40 meters.

**CyberWeave Swarm [Action]**

- **Attribute:** Control
- **Cost:** 1 Reserve, 1 AP
- **Effect:** You deploy an atmospheric sensor cloud (4-meter radius within 20 meters). Roll a **Control Success Test**: every 2 Success Points grants **+1 Upgrade** to all allied ranged attacks made against targets within the cloud. The swarm can be repositioned as an Action for 0 Reserve.

## CLASS MODS

Weaver Class Mods cost **25,000 Credits** each (socketed at Levels 3 and 5, max 2 active):

- **Extra Reserve:** Gain **+1 Reserve** (increasing baseline reservoir capacity from 4 to 5).
- **Reborn Weave:** When rolling a Success Roll on Weaver tests, disassemble an active Creation/Modification enhanced with Hits to score those Hits and **8 Success Points** automatically.
- **Revitalizing Weave:** When recycling a Creation/Modification, also regain a spent Reserve that would have recharged at the end of the turn.
- **Woven Bond:** Gain **+1 Upgrade** on any test made while using equipment or weapons you have Created or Modified.
- **Weave Infusion:** Spend **1 additional Reserve** on a Weave test to add **+3 Success Points** or score an additional **Hit**.

## PROGRESSION

At character creation, distribute **7 Points** among Create, Control, and Modify (base 1 / 1 / 1, max 5). You begin with **1 Weave**.

**WEAVER CHASSIS PROGRESSION (LEVELS 1-5)**

| LEVEL | BENEFITS UNLOCKED | CREDIT COST |
|---|---|---|
| Level 1 | Base Chassis, 7 Attribute Points (base 1/1/1), Starting Weave, 4 Reserve | **100,000 Credits*** |
| Level 2 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Weave (3 Abilities) | **20,000 Credits** |
| Level 3 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Class Mod Slot (Slot 1), +1 Weave (3 Abilities) | **40,000 Credits** |
| Level 4 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Weave (3 Abilities) | **75,000 Credits** |
| Level 5 | +1 Attribute Point, +1 Class Mod Slot (Slot 2) | **150,000 Credits** |

**The 100,000 Credit cost for Level 1 applies only when purchasing an additional class chassis after character creation; an operative's starting class chassis is free.*

### TACTICAL WEAVER ARCHETYPES

- **The Armament Smith:** Invests in *Create* paired with BoltWeave and HardWeave. Forges customized sniper rifles and ballistic barriers on demand, arming the entire cell from a single reservoir.
- **The Kinetic Striker:** Balances *Control* with SliceWeave and FloatWeave. Slices through armored enemy bulkheads with sweeping monomolecular ribbons, hovering weightlessly across the battlefield.
- **The Infiltration Specialist:** Synergizes *Modify* and *Control* with MirageWeave and CyberWeave. Coats allies in chameleon films, overrides security terminals with viral tendrils, and deploys crawler drones for remote reconnaissance.
- **The Cellular Medic:** Dedicated to LifeWeave, synthesizing restorative nutrient elixirs and deploying medical micro-swarms to knit torn tissue and restart vital organs mid-firefight.